

THE 2021 – 2030 INTEGRATED URBAN DEVELOPMENT STRATEGY OF THE CRAIOVA URBAN AREA

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URBAN REGENERATION

THE IMPORTANCE OF INTEGRATED URBAN REGENERATION IN THE SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT OF CITIES

The public space is a defining component for the attractiveness of a city and the quality of life it provides to its residents, representing the place where people can spend their free time, meet and build the community spirit. The quality and accessibility of public space play an important role in the quality of life of the city. The general term “public space” includes not only well-defined public spaces such as parks, public squares or playgrounds, but also the streets or façades of the buildings, all of which play an important role in the vitality and attractiveness of a city.

Public spaces fall into three main categories:

- **Surface-like public spaces:** large public spaces, with a cohesive role, which are a point of attraction in the city, such as parks, public gardens or the civic center.
- **Point-like public spaces:** small in size (less than 3 ha), mainly of local interest, such as squares, small squares or playgrounds for children, which take on the role of proximity facilities, important for the quality of housing in neighborhoods.
- **Linear-like public spaces:** connecting elements between the attractions of a city, such as pedestrian areas, boulevards, streets furnished with street furniture for leisure or socializing activities.

Given that urban regeneration is a priority at European level and a direction of action that can be financed from non-reimbursable external funds (the European Regional Development Fund and the Recovery and Resilience Facility) with an estimated budget of 1.5 billion EUR, the public authorities should take a proactive approach in identifying regeneration opportunities at the level of the cities they represent or at the level of the metropolitan areas they belong to, in which case the projects can be developed in partnership with the county councils.

By following an integrated approach, the public administration must establish the priority areas for urban regeneration. Interventions on public spaces must be designed under a cohesive vision, in order to avoid one-off interventions and to maximize the impact of investments on all hierarchical levels (municipal, neighborhood, one-off), constantly aiming to improve the quality of life.

The complete list of spaces eligible for urban regeneration through projects financed from non-reimbursable external funds, according to the emergency ordinance regulating these projects, are:

- a) central areas;
- b) historic and protected built areas;
- c) public spaces within collective housing complexes, housing complexes or areas with condominium-like housing, respectively;
- d) areas of central and secondary train and bus stations, railway stations and port railway stations located within or at the border of urban localities, whether they are in use, abandoned, or have a different use;
- e) cliffs, banks and islands of rivers, stream and lakes within the urban localities;
- f) mine tailings and closed landfills within the urban localities;
- g) unstructured peripheral residential areas, areas of degraded blocks of flats and informal settlements in the urban environment;
- h) disused industrial sites, areas with major disused infrastructures, disused military sites;
- i) urban public gardens and parks, dendrological parks, botanical gardens;
- j) urban agri-food markets.¹

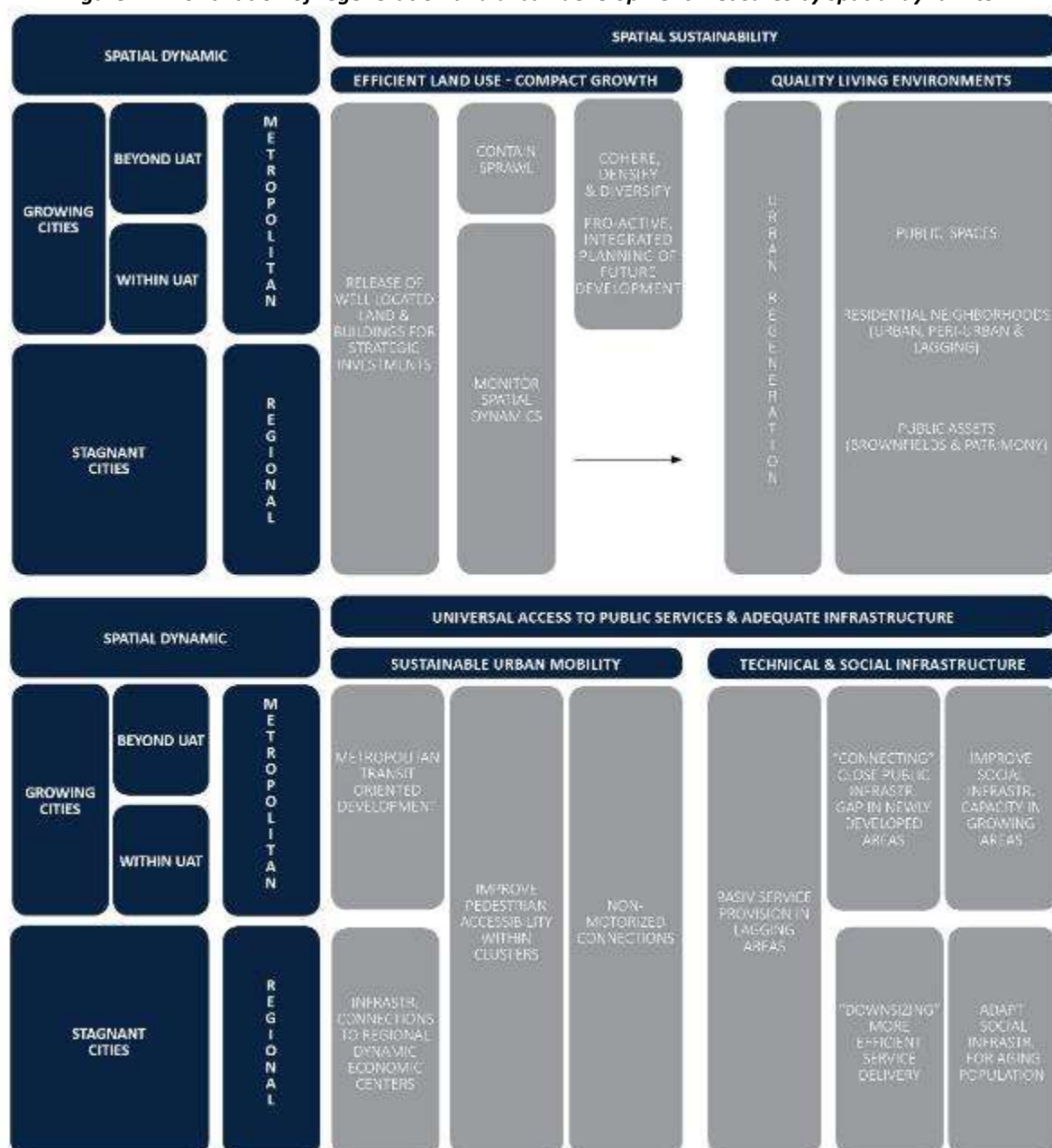
¹ The Ministry of European Investments and Projects, *GEO on establishing the measures for urban regeneration projects financed from non-reimbursable external funds.*

Regeneration interventions must be prioritized according to the different needs of the neighborhoods, as resulting from their urban analysis. Craiova is a complex city, which faces the dual problem of a declining quality of life in the neighborhoods of the urban core and an uncontrolled urban expansion in the peri-urban ring, manifested through:

- the aging of the building stock and the problem of parking lots in the dense neighborhoods of residential buildings
- the undeveloped infrastructure in
 - the less developed single-family housing neighborhoods and marginalized areas
 - the emerging peri-urban neighborhoods formed as a result of urban sprawl.

Therefore, the urban regeneration process should be guided both by the measures recommended in Romania's Urban Policy – the priority objectives of *spatial sustainability and fair access to quality public infrastructure and services*, and by **the specific needs and opportunities of each neighborhood**.

Figure 1. Prioritization of regeneration and urban development measures by spatial dynamics.



Source: the authors.

The following preparatory tools can facilitate the process of prioritizing and developing projects, while maximizing the impact of investments:

- Comprehensive and up-to-date inventory of green spaces, public spaces, heritage buildings and public assets with functional reconversion potential (disused industrial sites, disused military sites), for their preservation, regeneration and capitalization.
- Collaboration with other public or private entities, but also with neighboring administrations or the county council, in order to help make use of strategic resources that are not under the Municipality's administration (e.g. The blue-green infrastructure, disused industrial or military sites).
- Coordinating regeneration projects with other strategic objectives and investments, such as coordinating the rehabilitation of a public space with mobility plans or stimulating private investment in a priority area through investments in the quality of public spaces.
- Organizing urban planning and architecture design competitions to promote quality projects and innovative solutions.

The degree of attractiveness and the impact of a space on the community depends on the quality of the public space, its accessibility, image, functionality and degree of inclusiveness. Therefore, in shaping a quality public space, a wide range of issues must be considered, beyond the architecture and planning of the space, following four general levels: 1) access and connectivity, 2) proposed use and activities, 3) comfort and image, 4) impact on the social environment.

Figure 2. Hallmarks for a successful public space



Source: Processing of data from the Project for Public Spaces, in IUDS Bucharest.²

² Project for Public Spaces, *What makes a great place?*, <https://www.pps.org/article/grplacefeat>

THE RENOVATION WAVE – THE SUSTAINABLE REHABILITATION OF BUILDING

The age of the urban building stock is a challenge for the sustainable development of cities, a challenge faced both at national level where 87% of urban housing was built before 1990 and at the level of the European Union, where 85% of buildings were built more than 20 years ago and it is expected that 85% -95 % of them will exist in 2050.

The European approach, detailed in the *Renovation Wave* and the *European Green Deal*, aims to reduce energy consumption from fossil fuels for which the buildings are responsible, being one of the main consumers of energy, being responsible for 40% of total energy consumption in the EU, while in Romania, the household sector and the tertiary sector represent 45% of Romania's consumption.

- **accelerating the thermal rehabilitation of the building stock**, public and private, to achieve the goal of energy performance, by energy modernization of existing buildings, both by thermal insulation of the building envelope, as already practiced in Romania, and by modernizing centralized systems for the supply of thermal and electrical utilities;
- **increasing the number of buildings whose energy consumption is almost net zero (nZEB) for new buildings**, by using renewable energy sources and a high degree of energy efficiency.

The *Renovation Wave* will directly contribute to the preservation of buildings of cultural value and to increase the attractiveness of existing housing and the quality of life, thus contributing to the capitalization of built heritage, limiting uncontrolled urban expansion - suburbanization and reducing energy consumption generated by the construction industry.

Following the goal of energy efficiency, an integrated approach to renovation is recommended, both at the building level and at the neighborhood level, including seismic risk reduction, technical expertise of the resistance structure and if needed, the necessary reinforcements, interventions to make buildings more accessible for people with reduced mobility - especially in the context of aging population, but also other architectural interventions such as transforming the roof of buildings into public spaces or using them for the installation of solar panels, and the establishment of color and image guides at the neighborhood level, in order to adapt them to the new housing standards. This integrated approach is explored through **the *New European Bauhaus*** initiative, which encourages solutions at the crossroads of innovation, culture, social inclusion, science and technology.

The objectives of *The Renovation Wave* both at European and national level, can only be achieved through action at local level, aiming at:

- doubling the rate of renovation for energy efficiency at European level, as specified in the strategy - "*The Renovation Wave in Europe - Greening our buildings, creating jobs, improving the quality of life*" (2020);
- reduction of at least 30% of energy consumption for residential buildings and 30% of greenhouse gas emissions for public buildings, of projects financed from the National Recovery and Resilience Plan;
- targeting maximum efficiency thresholds and complying with European directives, national legislation and technical specifications for energy efficiency and construction of nZEB buildings, such as the *National Long-Term Renovation Strategy (SRTL)*, *nZEB Building Growth Plan* (2014), Law no. 372/2005 and Law no. 101/2020 regarding the amendment and completion of law no. 372/2005, according to EU Directive 2018/844 on energy performance and Directive 2012/27 on energy efficiency.

At the level of Craiova municipality, the state of the residential building stock, reveals the fact that out of the 3172 collective housing blocks analyzed, only 778 (24.6%) were totally thermo-insulated, 902 (28.4%) are partially thermo-insulated and 1492 (47%) have not yet been thermo-insulated - see fig. 20.

METHODOLOGY

This section briefly describes the process of analyzing public spaces for the purpose of urban regeneration, outlining the steps needed to understand the local context and shape the main directions of intervention. The analysis of public spaces and the urban regeneration strategy address the issue of regeneration through an approach that is structured according to the urban scale of the interventions:

- **regeneration of representative public spaces**, at municipal or metropolitan scale;
This category includes interventions aimed at revitalizing the historical areas, rehabilitating and expanding the green spaces and making use of the potential to capitalize on mobility corridors for use as public spaces.
- **regeneration of residential neighborhoods**, at the scale of neighborhood units and within urban islands – building blocks;
This category includes in particular specific interventions for the regeneration of collective housing compounds, those regarding connectivity and the functional and social mix in single family neighborhoods or those regarding the expansion and modernization of the technical municipal infrastructure and of the social and public transport connections in peri-urban areas.

Urban regeneration aims to improve the physical environment, the vitality and socio-economic dynamics of the urban environment by modernizing, rehabilitating or expanding the non-performing, degraded, poorly used or abandoned spaces or buildings, in order to increase the attractiveness of the city and the quality of urban life. When summarizing the literature and also the examples of best practice in the field of urban regeneration, we can notice the following **guiding principles**:

- *the principle of integrated urban regeneration*
- *the principle of connectivity and complete neighborhoods*
- *the principle of functional mix*
- *the principle of inclusiveness and social cohesion*
- *the principle of quality and authenticity in the rehabilitation of the public space*

The regeneration of the public space must be a priority objective for both sprawling and shrinking cities which face demographic, economic or spatial challenges, although the prioritization of actions may differ depending on the typology of the city and the specificities of the local context. Urban regeneration has a direct impact on the first three strategic objectives of Romania's Urban Policy:

- **green and resilient cities**, through interventions aimed at reducing the dependence on vehicles and promoting non-motorized travel, but also through interventions aimed at integrating, regenerating and capitalizing on the green spaces and the blue-green infrastructure, to increase the citizens' access to green spaces and to ensure a green and clean environment;
- **competitive and productive cities**, by creating quality public spaces that stimulate the city's attractiveness for housing, work and investment, but also by efficiently capitalizing on buildings and land that are well located for strategic investments;
- **just and inclusive cities**, by increasing equitable access to public utilities, services and facilities, by making the public domain accessible to all citizens – including the elderly or the disabled, and by creating inclusive community spaces that foster a community spirit.

Addressing the regeneration of representative public spaces

The regeneration of representative public spaces requires the simultaneous analysis of the following components and the integrated approach to their revitalization and interconnection:

- the green spaces and the elements of the natural setting;
- the central areas of the city/historic areas the protected built areas;
- the built heritage – cultural, architectural, industrial and public utility buildings;
- the main mobility corridors in the city.

The green spaces and natural environment resources were identified with the help of the *Register of Green Spaces* developed at city level, where available, of the information received from the General Directorate of the Public Domain, of the Google Maps platform, of the Corine Land Cover database and of the European Environment Agency Natura 2000 database³. The analysis of resources focused on the following assessment criteria:

- quantification of the area of the green spaces, in terms of per capita area, compared to the standard of 26 m² regulated at national and European level – this step is the first level of analysis, helping us identify opportunities and challenges in ensuring equitable access to public space;
- identification of the green spaces that are accessible to the general public, such as parks and public gardens – an important step, given that many of the areas quantified in the previous step are not set up as actual public spaces or do not have a satisfactory quality;

The main mobility corridors in the city were identified both by the empirical analysis of the urban fabric structure and by the “scientific” analysis, from a spatial (geometric) point of view, of the degree of accessibility of the street grid, the latter analysis being performed by Space Syntax Romania using their own methodological models. They are identified by analyzing the road system at a “global” level – i.e. the likelihood of a segment to be transited when using the shortest path between any two points in the system. These highly accessible streets coincide with the large arterial roads, but beyond the intensity of car traffic, these arterial roads open certain opportunities:

- they are conducive to economic activities, due to the high degree of accessibility and pedestrian traffic generated, but for this they must meet certain quality criteria, which make them conducive to pedestrian mobility and promenade activities;
- the street profile allows their reconfiguration as green corridors that connect and integrate the main green spaces, the elements of the natural environment or the attractions of municipal importance.

In addition, the main public spaces in the central area were analyzed – surface-like spaces (e.g. parks, civic markets), linear public spaces (e.g. pedestrian area, connecting elements), point-like spaces (e.g. squares) **and the cultural, architectural and industrial built heritage**, identified in the list of historical monuments drawn up by the Ministry of Culture, but also other objectives of local interest, which are not formally included in this list.

In order to prioritize and detail the urban regeneration measures, these spaces must be analyzed from a qualitative point of view, by assessing a few key aspects:

- the connectivity to the main pedestrian, public and non-motorized transport networks;
- the representativeness of the public space and the human scale of the urban elements;
- the existence and quality of street furniture, street lighting, shading, etc.;
- the accessibility for people with reduced mobility in the public space and its contribution to social cohesion.

³ European Environment Agency, Natura 2000 Network Viewer, <https://natura2000.eea.europa.eu/>

Addressing neighborhood regeneration

The aging building stock and the increasing dependence on cars have had a negative impact on the quality of life in residential neighborhoods. In the neighborhoods, there are two general issues:

- the limited access to neighborhood facilities and public spaces in the vicinity of homes, according to the principle of pedestrian accessibility;
- the prioritization of car traffic over non-motorized travel and the parking lots that suffocate the public domain, issues that affect the quality of the public space and pedestrian mobility.

At the same time, the challenges and opportunities vary according to the typology of the neighborhoods, requiring a differentiated approach for:

1. **the collective housing complexes from the socialist period**, comprising 69.7% of the urban dwellings, where the regeneration of the apartment blocks, the solving of the parking problems and a better access to endowments and quality public space must be prioritized.
2. **the areas of single-family dwellings within the urban core**, with a dense urban fabric, where priority should be given to facilitating pedestrian accessibility and increasing the access to neighborhood facilities.
3. **the rural settlements under the city's administration** where access to basic public services and connection to the urban core must be ensured.

Marginalized areas and informal settlements require an approach adapted to the living conditions of the identified communities, both through investments in infrastructure – from providing basic public services at affordable prices, to waste management and regeneration of the built stock or the construction of new social housing, and also through community development and social integration programs – retraining programs, social assistance, access to education.⁴

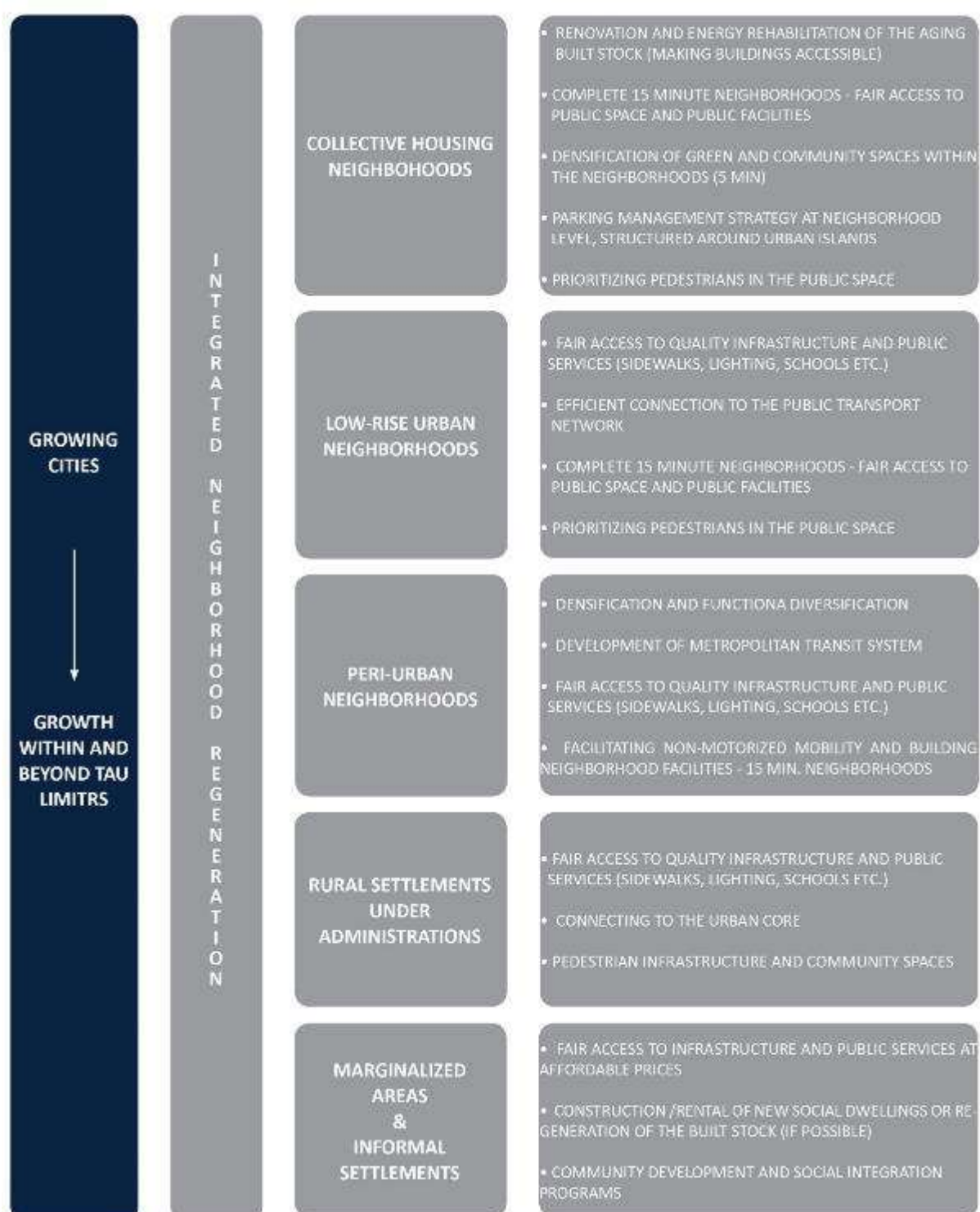
The neighborhood regeneration approach should aim at analyzing the built stock and identifying revitalization opportunities in a structured manner, according to the following principles:

- ***The principle of the integrated approach to green spaces***, which aims to capitalize on all green spaces in the neighborhood, from green pockets to parks, and to interconnect them, by consolidating green corridors along the main mobility axes, which will also define the boundaries of the neighborhoods.
- ***The principle of functional mix and of the complementarity of neighborhood facilities***, which aims to shape *complete 15-20 minute neighborhoods*, an urban planning concept that aims to facilitate access to a complete set of facilities close to home – public transport, school, kindergarten, sports field, playground, social spaces, convenience store, etc. This principle guides the prioritization of urban regeneration interventions in a neighborhood, aiming to obtain a complementarity of the activities and services offered.
- ***The principle of neighborhood units***, which aims to facilitate pedestrian accessibility of all residents to quality services and public spaces, by structuring interventions around *neighborhood units*, which follow the principle of pedestrian accessibility within a radius of 400 m (5 minutes), the optimal distance that can be comfortably walked on foot⁵. After implementing this principle, the interventions can go even further, by densifying the facilities around local communities, with a servicing radius of approximately 200 m (2.5 minutes).
- ***The principle of creating a hierarchy of the public space***, aiming at the configuration of urban islands, within which to reorganize the parking spaces and structure the open space according to the degree of accessibility, outlining both public and private spaces.

⁴ Romania's Urban Policy, Deliverable 3 – Contributions to Urban Policy 2020-2035, Accompanying document no. 8: *Marginalization, poverty and exclusion in Romanian cities*.

⁵ Jan Gehl, *Cities for People*, September 2010.

Figure 3. Urban regeneration measures for neighborhoods in dynamic cities.



Source: The authors.

URBAN REGENERATION OF REPRESENTATIVE PUBLIC SPACES

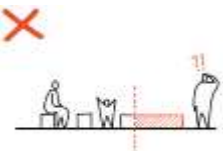
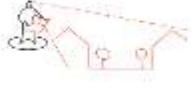
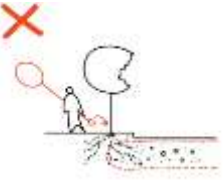
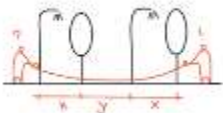
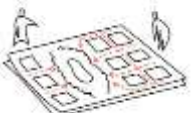
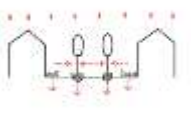
Best practices for the rehabilitation of the public space

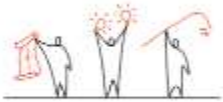
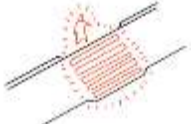
There are a number of principles for setting up public spaces according to their destination. In the table below we extract measures proposed for public spaces in general, green spaces, children's playgrounds, public spaces in historic neighborhoods and public spaces in new neighborhoods, referring to aesthetics, materiality, plant elements, urban elements, rainwater management or street furniture.

Public spaces are eminently pedestrian, with the possibility of bicycle access (a differentiation between speed and slow movement of the latter). A public space is also defined by the quality of its boundaries, the way the surrounding buildings look and how much is built between these boundaries (relative to how open it is).

Table 1 Proposed measures for surface-like and point-like public spaces

	Ideograms	Measures	P	H A	N N	PG	PS
1		Playgrounds should be integrated into the overall setup of the public space	x				
2		When choosing the location for a playground, the urban context and the wishes of the inhabitants should be considered.	x				
3		The scale of developments must be adapted to the context. The scale, zoning and capacity of the playground should be based on the characteristics of the chosen site.	x				
4		A fenced playground should only be implemented where certain safety measures require it.	x				
5		The role of playgrounds is to encourage the child's freedom and self-knowledge.	x				
6		In order to integrate the local community, playgrounds should attract people of different age groups. Picnic tables, games for all ages and seating should be integrated into the setup.	x				

	Ideograms	Measures	P	H A	N N	PG	PS
7		Any traffic safety element should be urban in nature. The fact that they are temporary must not be an excuse for a strictly utilitarian form that does not have a proper design.					x
8		Before the technical infrastructure is placed underground, a compositional and functional study of the public space to be modified is needed.		x	x		x
9		Underground utility routes must be positioned according to the existing tree alignments. They must allow the planting of trees in the future, depending on the characteristics of each public space. The roots must be prevented from passing through the planted strip and affecting the safety area of the utilities. Roots and technical infrastructures can be protected by various technological means, not just by their physical separation.	x	x	x	x	x
10		Drain grates and other open elements must be positioned with their gratings perpendicular to the direction of travel, not parallel to it.					x
11		In order to maintain the pace of the street and the tree alignment, all technical requirements for street lighting, overhead lines and the trees' biological needs must be taken into account in the technical and transport infrastructure plans.	x	x	x	x	x
12		Stormwater management can be applied to any public space. If the streets can't absorb all the water, it can be directed to the adjacent parks.	x	x	x	x	x
13		Any planned water area in the parks or any ornamental water systems should take rainwater management into account.	x	x	x	x	x
14		A decentralized sewerage requires an integrated landscaping concept within the public space, taking into account the local specificities.	x	x	x	x	x

	Ideograms	Measures	P	H A	N N	PG	PS
15		Street lighting should be considered in a broader context, in order to take into account both traffic safety and architectural, urban and aesthetic aspects, as well as the tiring effects of excessive light.					x
16		For pedestrian crossings, it is important that light is cast on pedestrians in order for drivers to see them, and vice versa.					x
17		The design of a light source should be chosen according to the general character of the area. For more important spaces, light sources with a different physical appearance from those used regularly can be used.		x			
18		If the street furniture design is not part of the overall architectural design of a space, local authorities and other managers should choose standard furniture from a catalog of urban furniture. If such a catalog is not available, it should be created.	x	x	x	x	x
10		Local governments should try to standardize the kiosks and create a unique design for the different sizes they can have.		x	x		x
20		The alignment renewal should be an integral part of street rehabilitation. The trees used to outline the alleys should have a straight trunk, allow trimming and withstand the harsher conditions in the urban environment. The correct arrangement of trees in a vegetation patch can make a positive contribution to creating a composition with intertwined crowns, outlining a unitary shaded public space.	x	x	x	x	x

Source: Guidelines for the rehabilitation of urban public spaces, World Bank, 2020⁶

⁶ Legend: P – playgrounds, HA – historic areas, NN – new neighborhoods, PG – parks and green spaces, PS – any public space

Regeneration of green spaces and capitalization of the natural environment

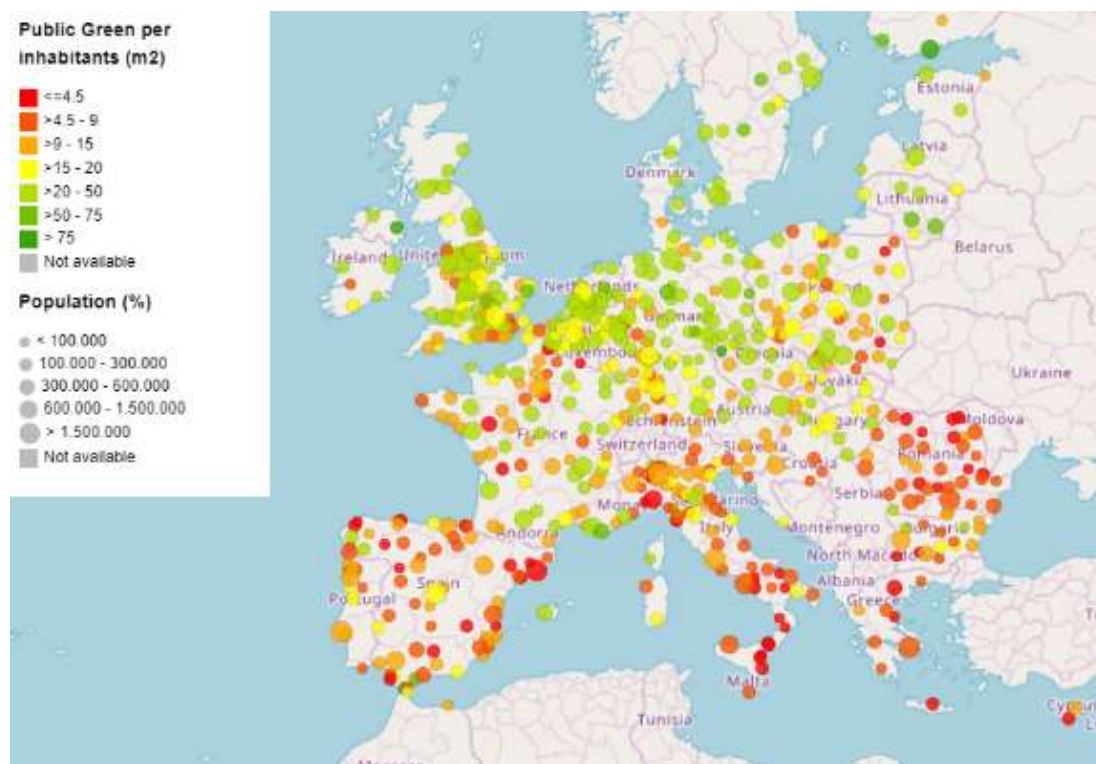
Green spaces are important not only for their aesthetic and recreational role, but also for the impact that green areas play in creating a healthy and pleasant environment for people. At the same time, green spaces can contribute to improving air quality, fighting the urban heat island effect, reducing urban noise or managing flood risks.

Access to quality green spaces directly influences the quality of life in the city, the well-being and health of the residents, so preserving and expanding green areas and facilitating the access of all citizens to green public spaces in the vicinity of housing must be a priority in urban development, despite possible policies for densification of certain urban areas.

At the same time, the blue-green infrastructure is an important resource for increasing the quality of life in cities, and municipalities should pay more attention to the smart use of these resources, both for recreational purposes and in adapting to climate change and combating urban pollution. In cities or at the peri-urban ring level there are often important vegetation resources, NATURA 2000 sites or lakes, which should be seen as a whole as an urban ecosystem that can make up for the limited green space inside dense neighborhoods or the lack thereof in new peri-urban neighborhoods.

According to legislative provisions at national and European level, cities must have a minimum of 26 m² of green space per capita, a threshold that 73.4% of cities in Romania do not comply with. However, even for those who meet this minimum criterion, it is important to also assess the quality of these spaces in terms of accessibility and facilities. In expanding the network of green spaces or regenerating existing spaces, it is important to follow the principle of fair accessibility, facilitating pedestrian access of all residents to a green space – Romania's Urban Policy recommends setting a standard of 15 m²/capita within a 10 minutes' walk radius (800 m).

Figure 4. Area of the accessible green public space per capita in the European Union



Source: JRC – Maes et al, 2019⁷

⁷ European Commission, *Space and the City*, <https://urban.jrc.ec.europa.eu/thefutureofcities/space-and-the-city#the-chapter>

The area of the green spaces available in Craiova City is 1039 ha, according to the data provided by NIS in 2019, which means an average of 38.51 m²/capita relative to the stable population in 2011 or 34.66 m²/capita relative to the domiciled population as of 1 January 2020. Craiova City meets the standard of 26 m²/capita. Craiova City ranks the third among the county seats, after Baia Mare and Bistrița, and first among the growth poles in terms of the green space area per capita. However, this average is below the 50 m²/capita recommended by the World Health Organization. On the other hand, the CORINE Land Cover satellite analysis indicates an area of green and recreational spaces of 670 ha in Craiova City, which represents 8% of the total area of the TAU, of which 354 ha (53%) is classified as “unfragmented natural area”, which means 11.81 m²/capita, relative to the domiciled population in 2020.

The area of the urban parks in the Craiova City is 206.23 ha, i.e. 6.88 m²/capita if we refer to the domiciled population as of 2020, respectively 7.65 m²/capita relative to the stable population since 2011. This is an indicator that more accurately reflects the population's access to quality public green spaces, as the total area of green spaces also includes properties that cannot be effectively used as public spaces, even if the reporting method varies between regions and countries. The average of the green space accessible to the public at the level of the European Union is 18.2 m² according to a 2019 study, average that is not met by any of the Romanian cities included in the study. The average of Craiova City in this study was 8.62 m²/capita.

In Craiova, 10 green spaces and parks of significant importance were identified at city level by their location, area and characteristics:

1. **Romanescu Park:** part of the city's heritage, an objective of national importance according to the classification made by the Ministry of Culture, covering more than 96 ha and dating back to 1903, being considered one of the most representative landscape art monuments in Romania.
2. **Tineretului Park** (former Lunca Jiului): covering an area of 150 ha, of which only 5% is covered by artificial/asphalted surfaces, enjoying a rich biodiversity and a special landscape potential. Craiova Water Park Here is located here, covering an area of 49,300 square meters.
3. **St. Dumitru Park** (Băniei Garden): covering an area of 23,800 square meters and concentrating several historical sites in Craiova, such as Casa Băniei, a monument of national interest and the Metropolitan Cathedral of St. Dumitru Church. This park also includes Trandafirilor Garden or Frații Buzești Garden, located in the south of the park.
4. **Unirii Garden (English Park) and the Prefecture Park:** located in the center of the city, in front of the Craiova City Hall building and on either side of the Prefecture building and of the Mihai Viteazul square, together forming an emblematic compound of public spaces.
5. **National Theater Park:** rehabilitated while setting up the underground parking in the area; it highlights the location of the Marin Sorescu Theater.
6. **Botanical Garden:** built in complementarity with the Romanescu Park in the south of the city to serve the northern area, it has an area of 16 ha and is considered one of the most beautiful botanical gardens in Romania, along with those in Cluj-Napoca, Bucharest and Iași.
7. **Pușkin - Crizantemelor Park:** located in the Pușkin residential neighborhood and near the Mircea Eliade Junior High School, serving the Siloz neighborhood. It is set up with benches and generous meadows and during the summer it can be activated by landscaping elements and urban furniture to facilitate outdoor activities and the use of green areas (hammocks, outdoor cinema, etc.).
8. **Mihai Bravu Garden:** located in front of the Faculty of Agronomy and the Dolj Court of Law - the Glogoveanu aristocratic house, a historical monument of national interest and next to the statue of Tudor Vladimirescu.

9. **Hanul Doctorului Park:** planned in the 1960s, but completed/revitalized in 2018 as a recreational area with fishing activities, in the residential area Plaiul Vulcănești, currently under development.
10. **Mureșului Park:** located near the Craiova County Emergency Clinical Hospital, in the south-western part of the city.

There are also areas with potential for recovery and regeneration, which will increase access to green spaces and leisure spaces:

- **green area around Craiovița Lake - Cernele Lake (Craiovița Park):** has the potential to become a recreational and promenade area, since a network of informal pedestrian alleys is already shaped here - it will be used to serve the Craiovița Veche, Cernele, Craiovița Nouă, Brestei neighborhoods, very dense areas, without parks.

Figure 5. Craiovița Lake - Cernele Lake and the urban fabric surrounding it.



Source: Google Earth

- **the banks of the Valea Șarpelui river - Tanchiștilor lake, in the Tancodrom area** - the former Valea Șarpelui landfill: although located on the northern outskirts of the city and bordered by industrial urban fabric (Oltenia Energy Complex Thermal Power Plant - Craiova II), the area can be used as a recreational space to serve both the inhabitants of Craiova, of the Șimnicu de Sus locality, but also those from the localities in the north of the peri-urban ring. Moreover, certain plots have developed here in a fragmented way, not having an adequate technical and municipal infrastructure, settlements whose attractiveness will increase as a result of the regeneration of the green space and which could be the subject of an integrated regeneration project, which will stimulate densification and compact growth in the area.

Figure 6. The Valea Șarpelui area and the evolution of the development areas around it 2004-2019.



Source: Google Earth

- **Cornițoiu Park (35,777 m²)** - the area is currently a vacant land covered by spontaneous vegetation, and in recent years, real estate projects have taken from the surface of the open space. Here, the municipality aims to develop a theme park (Dracula Park), which will be a point of attraction in the city and will serve the local communities in the neighborhoods of Craiovița Nouă, Brazda lui Novac and George Enescu.

Figure 7. Cornițoiu Park area and its spatial evolution 2009 - 2019.



Source: Google Earth

The location of municipal (representative) parks in the central area and in the W and S extremities of the city indicates a low degree of accessibility from the residential neighborhoods, especially those in the north and east of the central area. According to the data collected within the Romania's Urban Policy project, the degree of accessibility of the parks in Craiova is 43.71 min.⁸

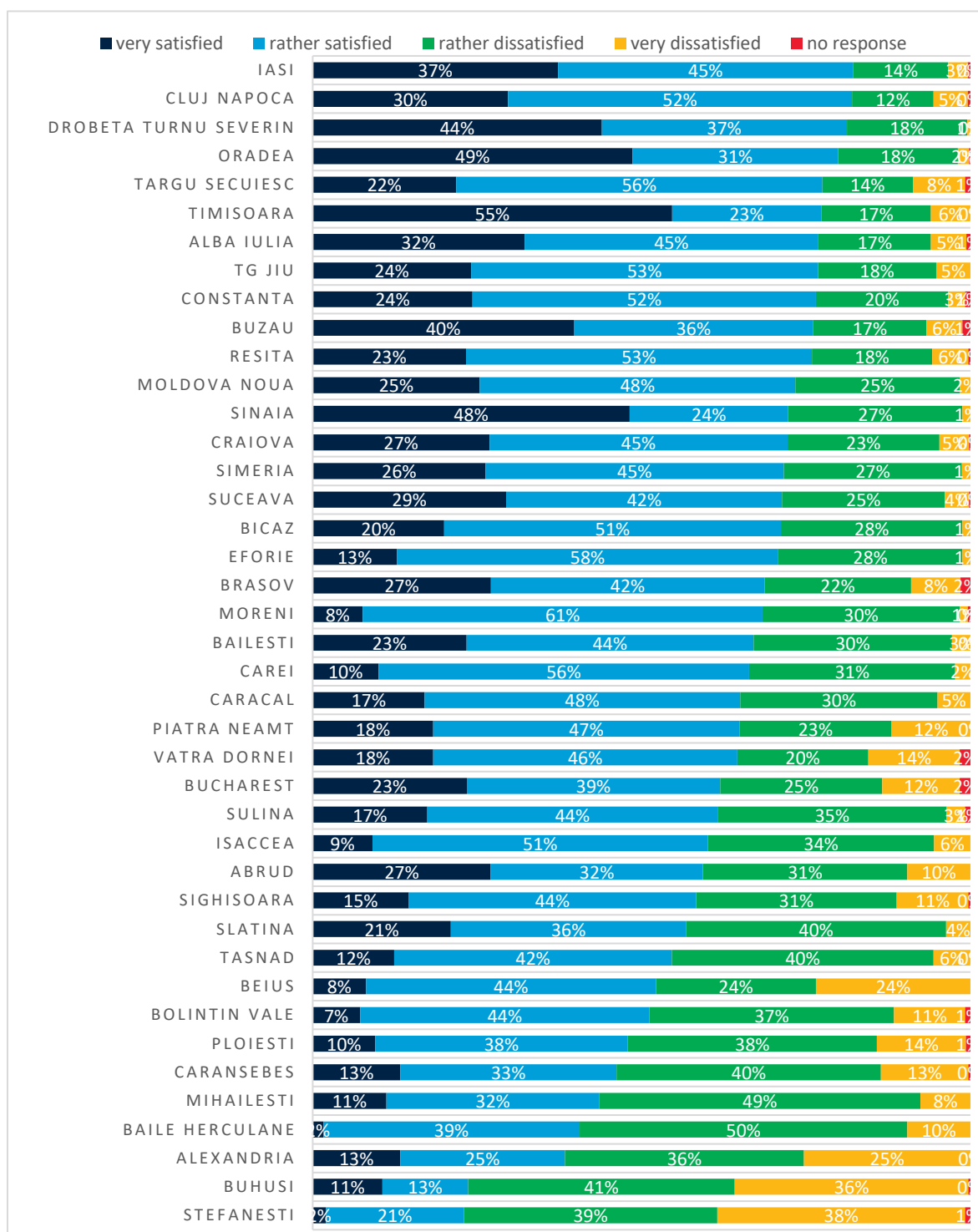
That is why it is important to capitalize on the green resources with large areas, previously identified, but also the open spaces inside the neighborhoods - spaces in the vicinity of apartment buildings covered with spontaneous vegetation and those recovered through a more efficient management of residential car parking lots. The high density of Craiova's neighborhoods makes it necessary to develop these analyzes at the neighborhood level as soon as possible, to identify opportunities to expand green spaces, to achieve the goal of a fair pedestrian accessibility to a green space within a 10-minute walk from home.

Moreover, given the expansion of the city towards the peri-urban area through new residential neighborhoods, but also the relatively low potential for significant expansion of the green area inside the built-up area, **natural resources** can be sought in the peri-urban area. **Around Craiova City, there are no forests with recreational potential within a radius of 1 km, but within a radius of 5 km there are 271.31 ha and another 63.73 ha within a radius of 10 km.**

⁸Romania's Urban Policy, European Framework for Sustainable Cities, Spatial Dimension: 5. Promoting the high quality and functionality of public spaces and living environment - 5.7. Accessibility of natural parks. <https://citadini.ro/baza-de-date-urbane/>

The degree of Craiova City citizens' satisfaction regarding the green spaces, analyzed as part of the Urban Barometer carried out within the Romania's Urban Policy development project, indicated that **72% of the population is satisfied or rather satisfied**, while only 5% said they were very dissatisfied, thus Craiova ranking 14th out of 41 cities analyzed.

Figure 8. How satisfied are you with the green spaces, such as the parks and gardens in your city... [your city]? - a comparison



Source: Romania's Urban Policy, Quality of Life Barometer 2020.

Regeneration of linear spaces – the main mobility corridors

Linear public spaces include both spaces dedicated to promenade and leisure activities, as well as representative pedestrian areas, the developed banks of the rivers or the portions of the boulevards provided with urban furniture, as well as all the streets of the city, which are essentially public spaces, even if too few are capitalized.

The streets have the potential to be reconfigured so that they stimulate economic activities, facilitate a safe and pleasant environment for walking or other non-motorized travel, to be green corridors and even function as a public space themselves, by implementing sharing policies or by setting up street furniture on the sidewalks. Urban regeneration measures for these areas should simultaneously pursue the following directions of action:

- **improve the quality of the representative line-like public spaces**, such as pedestrian alleys, as an integral part of the regeneration of the central areas or green corridors;
- **regenerate the main mobility corridors of municipal importance**, improve connectivity in the urban environment and change the paradigm of prioritizing modes of travel, from car to pedestrian and non-motorized means: pedestrian> cyclist> public transport> personal car;
- **reconfigure the streets in the residential neighborhoods**, facilitate pedestrian movements, share the streets and revitalize the façades and activities on the ground floor of the blocks of flats – the measures will be elaborated in the chapter dedicated to the integrated regeneration of the neighborhoods.

At the level of Romanian cities, there are four street categories, depending on traffic intensity and on the role, they have in the structure of the street layout and the city. Each category presents different opportunities and limitations for urban regeneration, but a dominant feature of these, at present, is the fact that measures and interventions are prioritized towards the comfort of the vehicle, to the detriment of pedestrians and other means of transport.

- Category I streets – main roads:
- Category II streets – connecting streets:
- Category III streets – collector streets:
- Category IV streets – for local use:

Category I and II streets play an important role in the connectivity of the city, taking over the major flows of the city and ensuring the connection between the functional and residential areas. They often coincide with important arteries for the city's economic activity and for connecting the main public spaces or cultural objectives, thus requiring special attention to the safety and comfort of pedestrians or cyclists. A street that is carefully configured for the human scale, with vegetation, adequate public lighting and urban furniture, will have a positive impact on economic activities and will become a space for walking and socializing.

The economic dimension and the social dimension are mutually reinforcing, but both are conditioned by the quality of the public space setup – a street with shops, but unfriendly to pedestrians, or one carefully designed for pedestrians but lacking a functional mix will not generate the necessary pedestrian flow for economic activities to flourish. A safe street, with spaces for rest and socialization and economic diversity, will always be attractive and will have great economic potential.

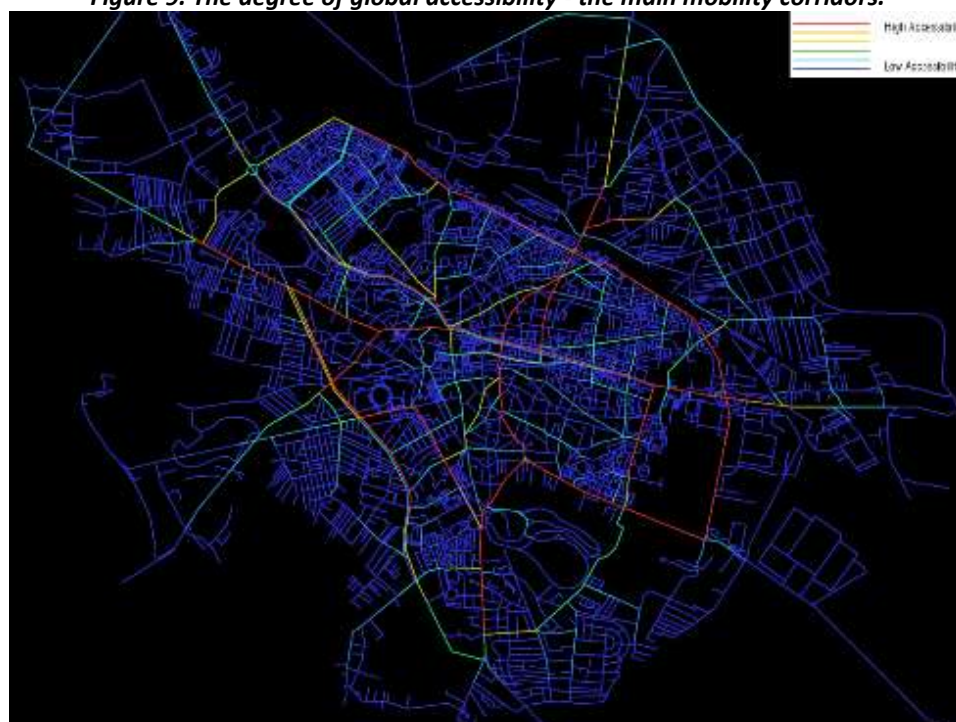
A paradigm shift is needed in prioritizing the means of transport, through an approach focused primarily on reducing dependence on vehicles and facilitating public transport and non-motorized travel, in order to achieve the goals of sustainability and resilience and build a green city with quality public spaces.

The analysis developed by Space Syntax (Annex 1) identified the main mobility corridors with a high degree of accessibility, detailed in the table below. These coincide with the streets with a high traffic, with the main public transport lines and with a more dynamic economic activity, being therefore intensely used by pedestrians. They are listed in the tables below.

Table 2 Streets with a high degree of global accessibility (1.2 km - 15 min.), of city importance

Area with regeneration potential	Related recommendations
Calea București	Increasing the quality of pedestrian space and facilitating a safe and comfortable environment, which involves: - Investments in pedestrian infrastructure to ensure sufficiently wide, unobstructed sidewalks, adequate public lighting, a sufficient number of pedestrian crossings and even a level of shading capable of increasing pedestrian comfort during the summer; - Enforcement of legislation on illegally parked cars on sidewalks and installation of physical barriers to stop this practice, such as planters, parking limiters/bollards, or other elements of vegetation or urban furniture. - Setting up spaces for rest and recreation, by introducing urban furniture elements in the squares and green areas in front of apartment buildings and in areas where the width of the sidewalks allows it. - Reconfiguring the street profile to expand the public space, calm the traffic and where possible, to delimit a line dedicated to public transport.
Nicolae Titulescu Blvd.	
Carol I Blvd.	
Caracal Str.	
Frații Golești Str.	
Corneliu Coposu Str.	
Nicolae Romanescu Blvd.	
1 Mai Blvd.	
Râului Str. – segment between Dr. Dimitrie Gerota Str. and Elena Theodorini Str.	
Elena Theodorini Str.	
Breștei Str.	
Decebal Blvd.	
Dacia Blvd.	
Henri Coandă Str.	
Ilie Balaci Blvd.	
Râului Str.	

Figure 9. The degree of global accessibility - the main mobility corridors.



Source: Space Syntax for IUDS Craiova - Annex 1.

Regeneration of the central area and of the protected built areas

The historical areas, the protected ones and the civic centers of cities have an important role in strengthening the local identity through their authenticity and architectural richness, being elements that must be protected and highlighted. The main representative public spaces of the city, such as public squares and pedestrian streets, are usually also found in the central area, thus concentrating economic and recreational activities that give dynamism to public life.

The quality of public spaces is essential to the attractiveness of the central area, both for leisure activities aimed at locals and tourists. The quality of the buildings, public spaces and the easy connections between them are important in capitalizing on historical areas and cultural specificity for tourism purposes, but also in creating an attractive environment for investors. In order to protect the specificity of the place, it is necessary to regulate and implement measures to ensure compliance with the architectural context in future interventions and constructions. Jan Gehl identifies the following essential elements of a quality public space, that should energize public life⁹:

- **Protection**
 - Protection against vehicular traffic
 - Protection of the public space against crime and violence (crime prevention)
 - Protection against unpleasant sensory experiences (rain, wind, heat)
- **Comfort**
 - Invitations for walking
 - Invitations for standing and staying
 - Invitations for sitting
 - Invitations for seeing
 - Invitations for hearing & talking
 - Invitations for play and recreation
- **Quality of the public space/Enjoyment**
 - Dimensioned at a human scale
 - Positive aspects of climate (sun, shade, etc.)
 - Aesthetic quality

The traditional squares of the historic and compact areas of a city, defined by the surrounding buildings, are usually among the highest quality public spaces. The quality of a square is also dependent on its proportions (for example, the ratio between the area and the height of the surrounding buildings). Often, public spaces (re)designed in the socialist period were not conceived at a human scale, but as large open spaces, creating a hostile environment for recreational activities. Small structures, urban furniture and trees can create a pleasant transition from the street level to the height of the surrounding buildings. At the same time, there should be continuous pedestrian connectivity within and between the public spaces, because barriers to the natural movement of the pedestrians fragment the public space, reduce the dynamism of isolated spaces and have a negative impact on the perception of public space quality.

The old town of Craiova, recently rehabilitated through a EU-funded project in the form of a pedestrian area, concentrates numerous cultural institutions, museums, administrative buildings, churches, but also a series of houses with architectural value, which are on the list of historical monuments. The area of Craiova's old town is delimited perimetally by C.S. Nicolaescu Str. – Plopșor Str., Alexandru Ioan Cuza Str., Arieș Str., C.D. Fortunescu Str. and Mihail Kogălniceanu Str., the streets inside being mainly intended to be used for pedestrian traffic, highlighting the buildings in the area. Mihai Viteazu Square - City Hall. The main promenade and *leisure* relaxation area is also located here, because, after the restoration of the old town, numerous shops, restaurants, terraces and cake shops appeared here, activating and concentrating the public life.

⁹ Gehl Institute, The Public Life Diversity Toolkit 2.0, 2016

Representative public spaces in the city center include Buzești Square, the original core around which the city was built, the former political center (Casa Băniei), the religious center (St. Dumitru's Church) and the commercial center (Elca Square), developed mainly in the second half of the 17th century, being located here. Also, around the old town we find the four palaces of Craiova, Băniei Garden, Marin Sorescu National Theater, Unirii Garden, Prefecture Park, but also most of the monuments of national importance.

The **cultural infrastructure** of Craiova City is a rich one, totaling 27 institutions, concentrated in the central area of the city, many of which have already been rehabilitated. These are points of interest in the city and are part of the network of public spaces. Cultural institutions are classified as follows:

- 7 museums, 3 art galleries and one art collection:
 - The “St. Nicodim” museum of the Center for Restoration, Heritage Conservation and Visualization of the Craiova Archdiocese and the Museum Collection of the Orthodox Metropolitan Church of Oltenia,
 - the Art Museum that has been operating since 1954 in the building of the Constantin Mihail Palace, a building built between 1898 and 1907, which is considered one of the most beautiful architectural monuments in the city (arch. Paul Gottereau). It was rehabilitated with support from ROP 2007-2013 through structural, restoration and architecture works, electrical/ventilation, sanitary and heating works, being reopened in 2015.
 - The Oltenia Museum operates in four buildings with special architectural value: Ethnography Section, Casa Băniei - a Brâncovesc style building, History-Archeology Section whose rehabilitation was completed in 2012, Natural Sciences Section).
 - Marin Sorescu National Theater Museum and Art Gallery no. 2 belonging to the Ministry of Culture.
 - Art Gallery belonging to UAPG
 - Electroputere Gallery belonging to the Craiova Local Council.
- 5 performance institutions with a total of 1,703 seats:
 - Marin Sorescu National Theater, whose rehabilitation and modernization documentation was submitted in August 2020, since this building needed consolidation works, thermal rehabilitation, interior partitioning changes to comply with ISU norms and technical interventions at the level of performance spaces and of the technical ones.
 - Romanian Opera in Craiova, where the rehabilitation project is underway, currently the technical-economic indicators being approved, and the procurement procedure will be initiated. This project has a total duration of 30 months.
 - The Oltenia Philharmonic has classical concert halls, but it also operates in unconventional spaces.
 - The Summer Theater, located in Nicolae Romanescu Park, was rehabilitated with support from ROP axis 2007 - 2013 and it has 878 seats.
 - The Colibri Children's and Youth Theater has 370 seats, but it also operates in unconventional spaces.
- Traian Demetrescu Culture Club
- Elena Farago Memorial House
- Dolj County Directorate for Culture
- County Center for the Conservation and Promotion of Traditional Culture Dolj
- Craiova Zoo

● PARCURI	● SPAȚII PUBLICE REPREZENTATIVE	● INFRASTRUCTURĂ CULTURALĂ
1. Grădina Mihai Bravu	1. Grădina Zoologică Craiova	1. Teatrul Național "Mihai Eminescu"
2. Parcul Trandafirii / Grădina Săriei	2. Castelul Ferencat	2. Muzeul Olteniei – Secția de Istorie și Arheologie
3. English Park	3. Sa-a Politehnicii	
4. Parcul Prefecturii	4. Palatul Metropolitan (Metropolitan Office) și Birou de Lemn (Lești Șerpi)	● INFRASTRUCTURĂ SPORTIVĂ
5. Parcul Teatrului Național	5. Școala Adolfini (Măiri) – Duminău	1. Stadionul Teatrului
6. Parcul Fuskin – Căzantelor	6. IMediana Dădău	2. Club Sportiv Voivoda
7. Parcul Mureșului	6. Casă Băie	3. Stadionul Letensky
8. Parcul 1 Decembrie 1918	7. Școala Metropolitană Sf. Dumitru	
	8. Casa Glogoveanu – Tribunalul Dolj	
	9. Casa Nicușor Romanescu	
	10. Casa Scriitoarei Elena Farago	
	11. Palat Hoșii Sușești	
	12. Palatul Administrativ – Prefectura și Palatul Mihail Stănescu	
	13. Palatul Banca Comerțului – Prâsăria	
	14. Palatul Concursului Măști (Muzeul de Artă)	
	15. Palatul de Lectură (Universitatea din Craiova)	

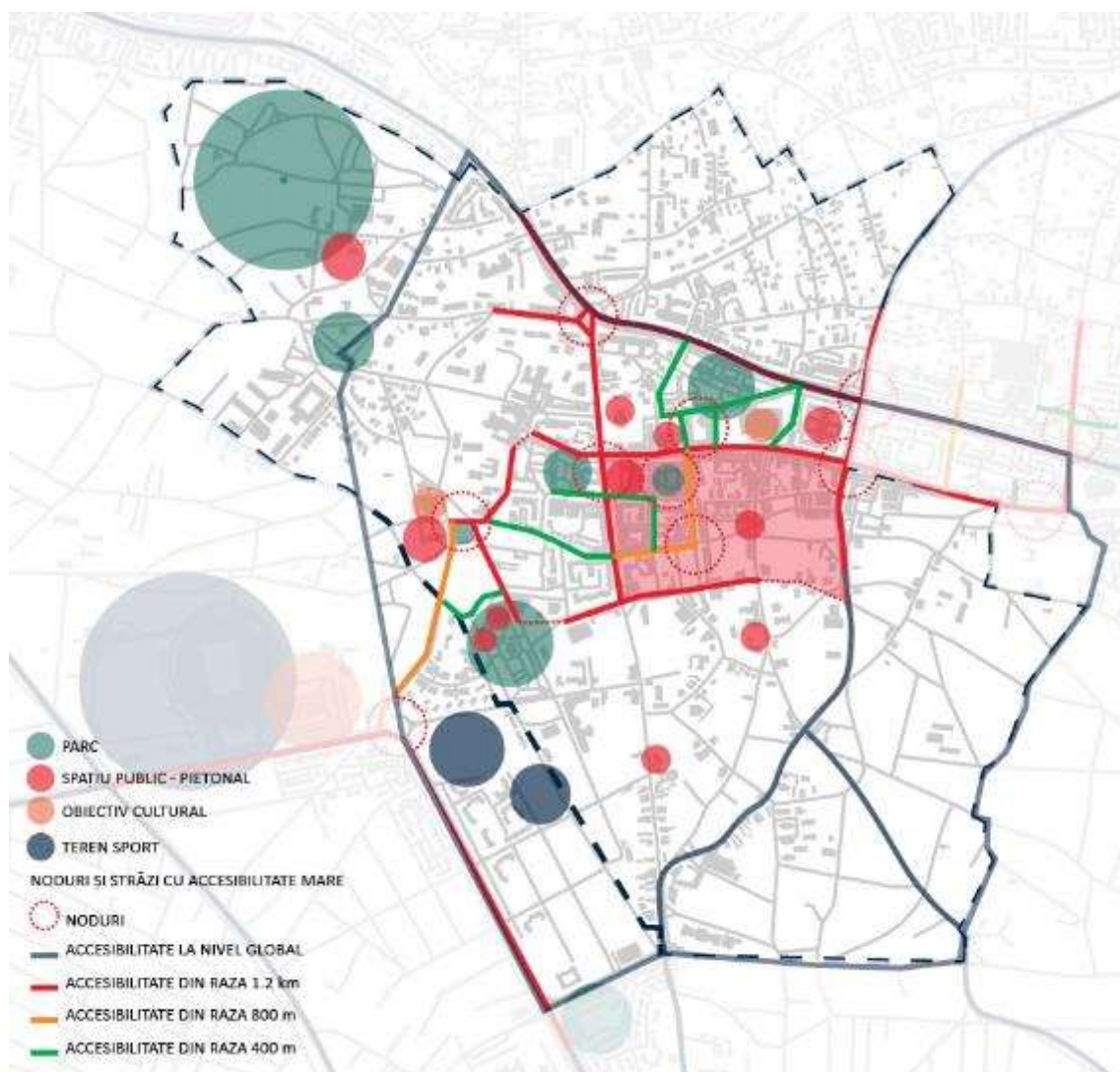
¹⁰For the legend, see Figure 11.

The *Space Syntax* analysis indicates the arterial roads and nodes in the central area that have a high degree of pedestrian accessibility geometrically. Due to the pedestrian flow generated, these streets are suitable for carrying out economic activities, while the nodes are suitable for setting up public spaces for socializing and rest.

In order to be capitalized for economic and recreational purposes, they must have a high-quality urban space, starting from the quality of the pedestrian space, urban furniture and landscape elements on a human scale and the appearance of the surrounding facades. The map and the table below identify the main streets and nodes with a high degree of accessibility, identified in the Space Syntax analysis and propose a series of specific recommendations for them.

The quality of the built heritage, especially of the facades is also important for the attractiveness of the area, and the municipality should pay special attention to projects for the rehabilitation of building facades, both public buildings and residential buildings, and by collaboration with the owners of heritage buildings.

Figure 11. Highly accessible streets and nodes compared to the main ones in the central area



Source: the authors, based on the Space Syntax accessibility study and Open Street Maps.¹¹

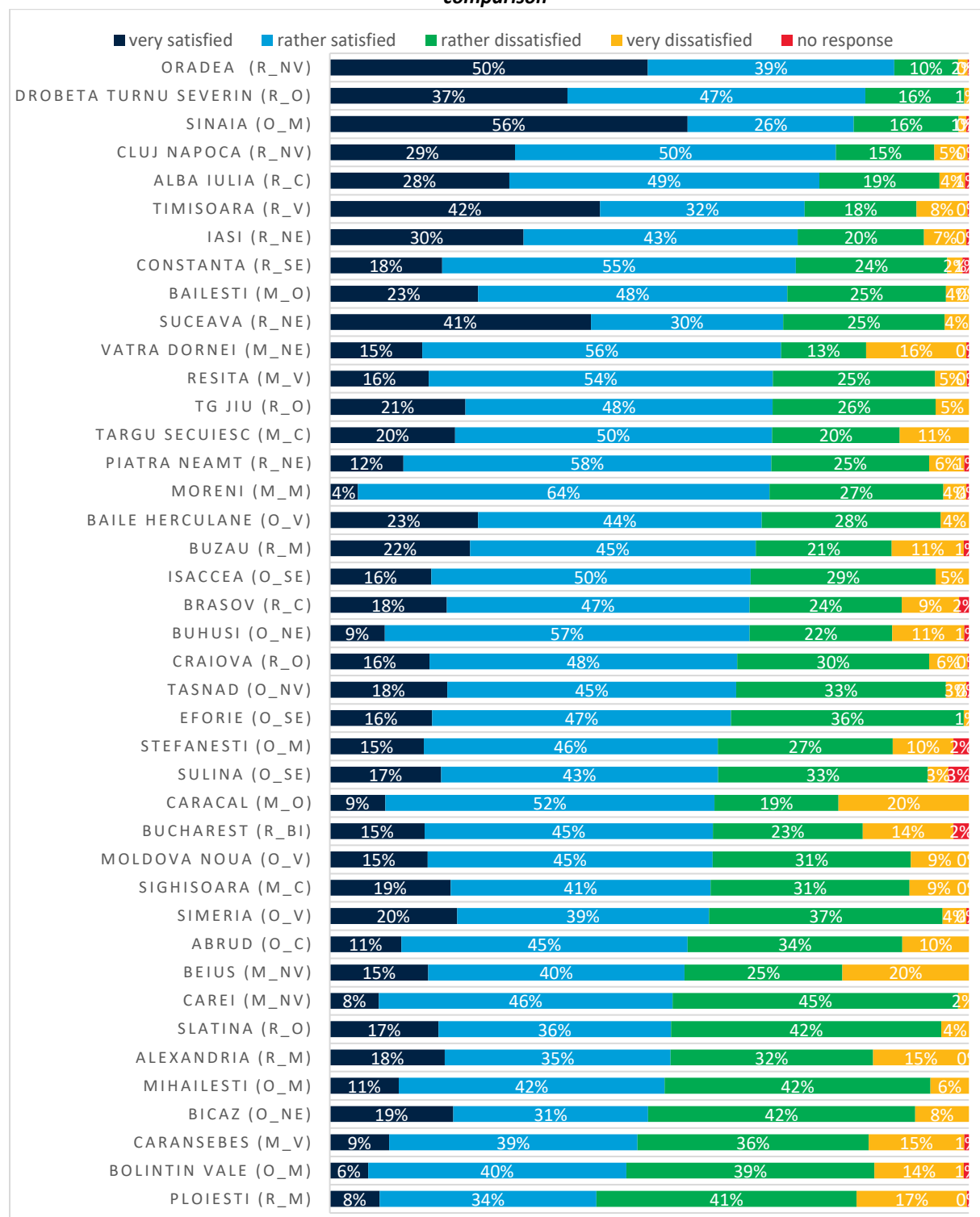
¹¹ Legend: *parc* = park, *spatiu public – pietonal* = pedestrian or public space, *obiectiv cultural* = cultural site, *teren sport* = sports field, *noduri și străzi cu accesibilitate mare* = nodes and streets with high accessibility, *noduri* = nodes, *accesibilitate la nivel global* = global accessibility, *accesibilitate din raza ...* = accessibility radius ...

Table 3 Streets and nodes with a high degree of accessibility, with potential for capitalization at the level of the central area.

Area with regeneration potential	Related recommendations
1. Calea Unirii	Increasing the quality of pedestrian space and facilitating a safe and comfortable environment, providing urban furniture in the wider squares or sidewalks, landscaping interventions, encouraging economic activities, collaborating with cafe/restaurant owners to create dedicated spaces for terraces.
2. Calea București	
3. Alexandru Ioan Cuza Str. – Popa Șapcă Str.	
4. Mihail Kogălniceanu Str.– St. Dumitru	
5. Arieș Str. - Universității Passage	
6. Mate Basarab Str. – between Madona Dudu Str. and Sfântu Dumitru Str.	Increasing the quality of the pedestrian space and facilitating a safe and comfortable environment, by decreasing the dominance of the car in the public space. It is necessary to apply the legislation on illegally parked cars on sidewalks and/or to install physical barriers to stop this practice, but also to build a dedicated infrastructure for them - e.g. underground parking. These operations will increase the quality of the urban space, energizing the public space.
7. Ion Maiorescu Str.	
8. Bibescu Str.	
9. Theodor Aman Str.	
10. Lipscani Str. – Madona Dudu Str.	
11. Olteț Str. – C.S. Nicolaescu Plopșor Str.	
12. Teatrului Alley	Integrating the alley with the public spaces around it, the park and the esplanade of the Marin Sorescu Theater and ensuring a safe and comfortable environment for pedestrians, by reconfiguring it as a shared space.
13. Node: Unirii Square	The nodes at the intersection of the main mobility corridors concentrate economic activity and a high pedestrian flow, but the quality of the space is negatively influenced by the high volume of car traffic. It is thus recommended to also ensure continuous and quality flows for pedestrians and cyclists between public transport stations and to implement traffic calming measures.
14. Node: Carol I Blvd. and Calea București	
15. Node: Alexandru Ioan Cuza Str. and Universității Passage	
16. Node: Calea Unirii – Popa Șapcă Str. – Olteț Str.	
17. Node: Ilie Balaci Blvd. and 1 Mai Blvd.	Nodes located at the intersection of secondary streets that can be used for economic activities and as secondary social spaces. Their quality is negatively affected by the parked cars/dominance of the cars.
18. Node Lipscani Str. – Theodor Aman Str.	
19. Node: Teatrului Alley – Romul Str. – Theodor Aman Str.	
20. Node: Matei Basarab Str. – Madona Dudu Str. – Maiorescu Str.	

The satisfaction degree of Craiova's inhabitants regarding the condition of public spaces in the city, analyzed as part of the Urban Barometer carried out within the Romania's Urban Policy development project, indicated that **64% of the respondents are very satisfied or rather satisfied**, but only 16% of them are very satisfied, and 6% are very dissatisfied, thus Craiova ranking 22nd out of 41 cities analyzed.

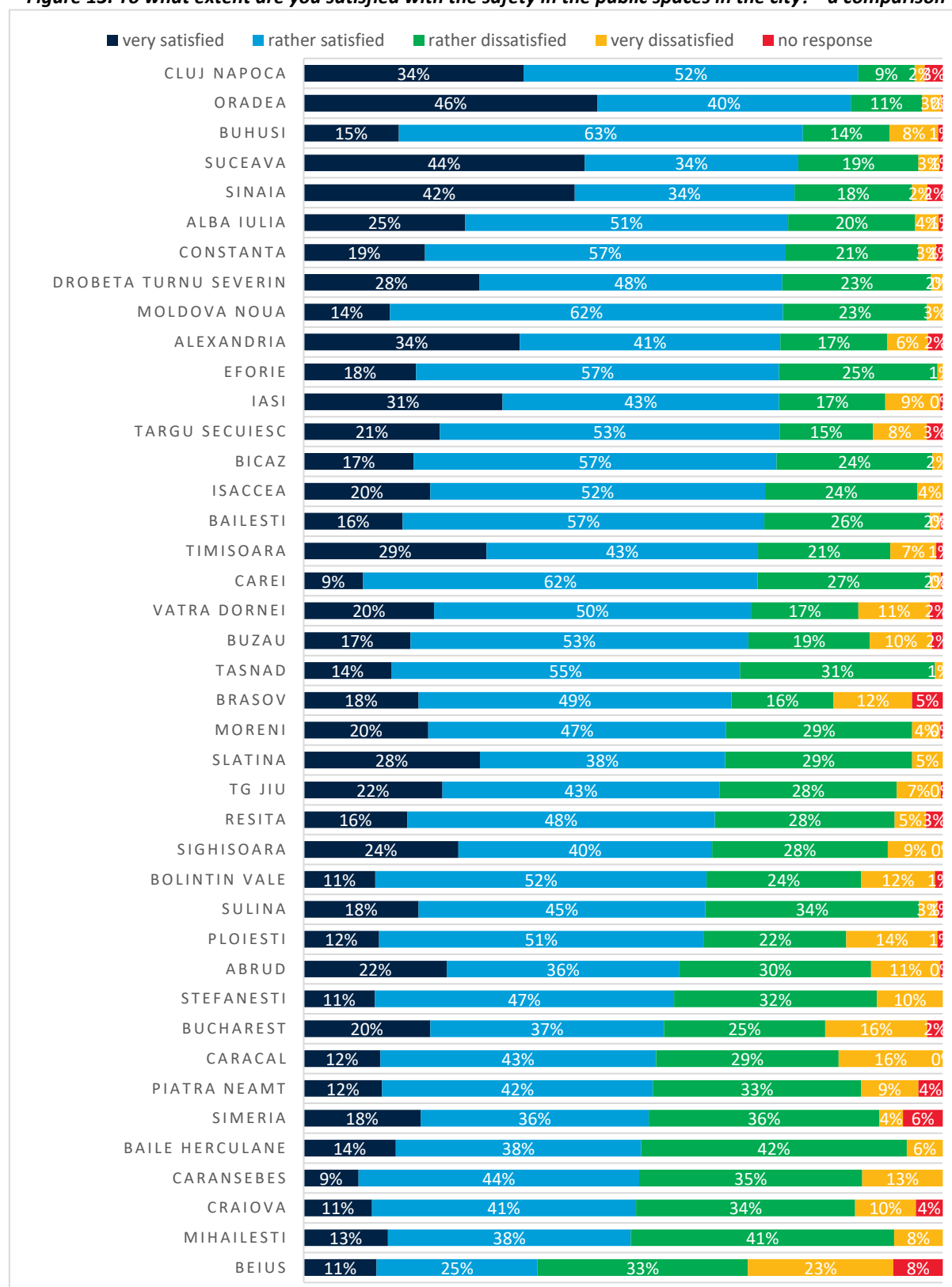
Figure 12. How satisfied are you with public spaces, such as public squares, pedestrian areas in your city? - comparison



Source: Romania's Urban Policy, Quality of Life Barometer 2020.

In terms of safety in public spaces, Craiova ranks 38th out of 41, with a percentage of only 11% of the population saying they are very satisfied, while 56% said they were rather dissatisfied or very dissatisfied.

Figure 13. To what extent are you satisfied with the safety in the public spaces in the city? - a comparison



Source: Romania's Urban Policy, Quality of Life Barometer 2020.

Regeneration of the built heritage

The built heritage plays an important role in strengthening local identity and authenticity, both cultural heritage and protected historical monuments, as well as other buildings representative of the local community or the history of the city, whether they are part of a city's industrial heritage or buildings hosting public functions of municipal interest such as railway stations, bus stations or agri-food markets. Their careful analysis in the urban context is necessary for the process of prioritizing urban regeneration projects, and it must follow these directions:

- **Identifying vulnerable heritage sites and buildings that need rehabilitation**, modernization or additional urban regulations in the area, in order to protect their architectural value, increase their functionality and better integrate them into the urban fabric;
- **spatializing and connecting cultural objectives** through pedestrian corridors, bicycles or public transport routes, in order to unify the way they are presented and crystallize the cultural identity of the city, thus having a direct impact on tourist attractiveness;
- **the functional reconversion of abandoned heritage buildings**, aiming to capitalize on them for the benefit of the local communities (e.g. neighborhood centers) and accelerating the regeneration process, by establishing public-private partnerships with investors interested in rehabilitating and carrying out economic/civic activities or by other fiscal instruments to stimulate the rehabilitation of privately owned valuable buildings.

Craiova City has a rich architectural and cultural heritage, built due to its position as a key city in national history, the center of great historical decisions since the 15th century, Craiova being considered in the past the second capital of the country or the capital of the Romanian aristocracy. The cultural profile of Craiova was marked by the personalities of the city who contributed to the establishment of the first educational institutions in Wallachia, but also by boyars, aristocrats and rulers who attracted architects and artists from the country, but also from France, Germany or Italy, who offered the city numerous buildings with a special architecture, among which buildings belonging to the Brâncovenesc, Renaissance, Baroque, Classical, Neoclassical or Romantic style stand out. Although the city was deeply transformed during the communist period, many heritage buildings were saved from the demolitions of this period, positioning Craiova on a leading place among the Romanian cities that can be proud of their rich architectural heritage.

According to the data provided by the Ministry of Culture, Craiova has a significant number of monumental buildings in the country, 310 in Craiova City and 7 in its dependent localities - 1 in Rovine, 4 in Mofleni, 1 in Popoveni, 1 in Șimnicu de Sus, among them 15 monuments of national or universal interest, representing a percentage of 5% of the total, while the other 305 (95%) are of local interest. Those of national interest are:

- The ensemble of the Craiova Archdiocese and the Metropolitan Church of Oltenia
- The *Assumption of the Virgin Mary* Church (Madona Dudu)
- *All Saints* Wooden Church
- Băniei houses
- Glogoveanu House (Dolj Court)
- Nicolae Romanescu House
- House of the writer Elena Farago (Alexandru and Aristia Aman Library)
- Vârvoreanu House (Metropolitan Palace)
- Carol I High School
- Administrative Palace (Prefecture)
- Trade Bank Palace (Craiova City Hall)
- Constantin Mihail Palace (Art Museum)
- Palace of Justice (University of Craiova)
- Nicolae Romanescu Park

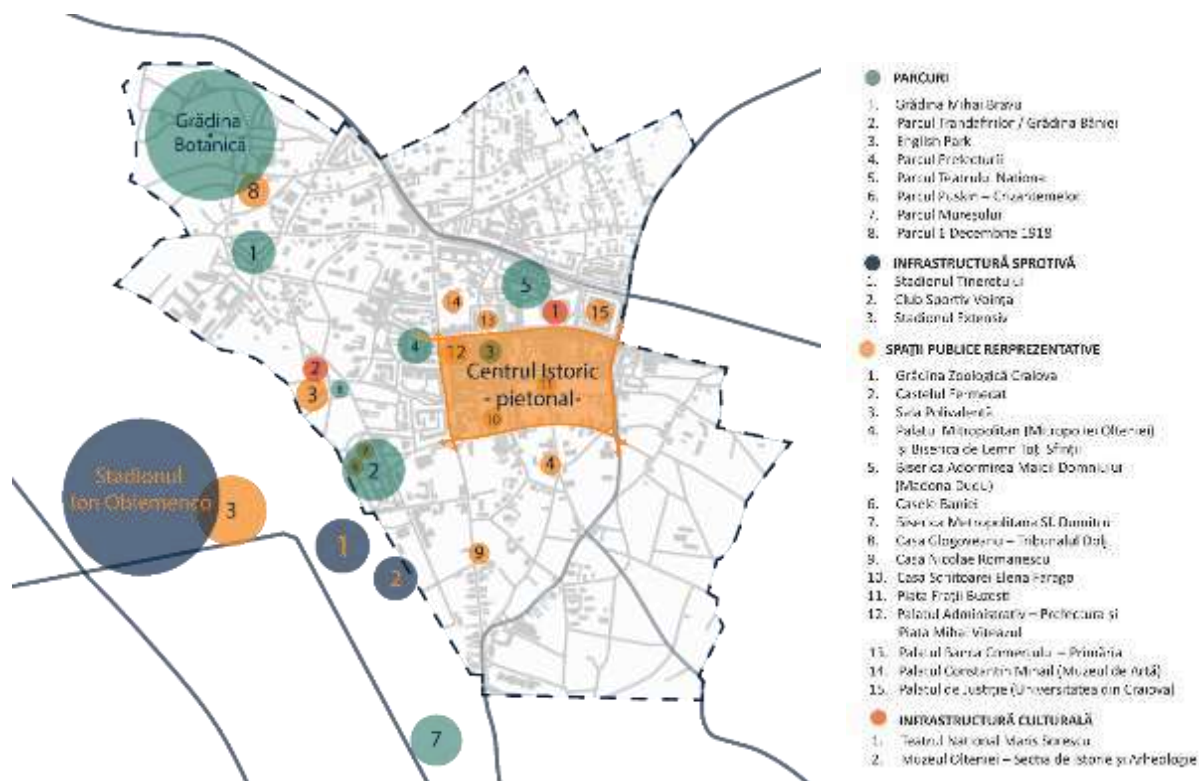
From a structural point of view, the monuments are classified into four categories depending on their nature, and at the level of Craiova City they are classified as follows:

- 265 or 85.5% are of type II - architectural monuments,
- 17 or 5.5% are of type III - public forum monuments,
- 28 or 9% are of type IV - memorial and funerary monuments

Namely, the 310 monuments in Craiova include:

- 33 churches and monasteries
- 190 architectural heritage houses
- 30 funerary monuments
- 8 busts and statues
- 5 fountains
- hotels
 - o the former Pallace Hotel - currently, the administrative building of Craiova City Hall
 - o Metropol Hotel
 - o Minerva Hotel
 - o New York Hotel
- 5 former factories and plants: *A. Weichmann* engine factory - today the didactic workshop of the University of Craiova, *Hoffenschranz* factory, *Florica* factory, *Trailul* factory - the chimney, the former Power Plant - currently, gym
- National Bank of Romania, Dolj Branch
- Filantropia Hospital - administrative building, stationary pavilion C
- Food hall
- Jean Negulescu Cinema

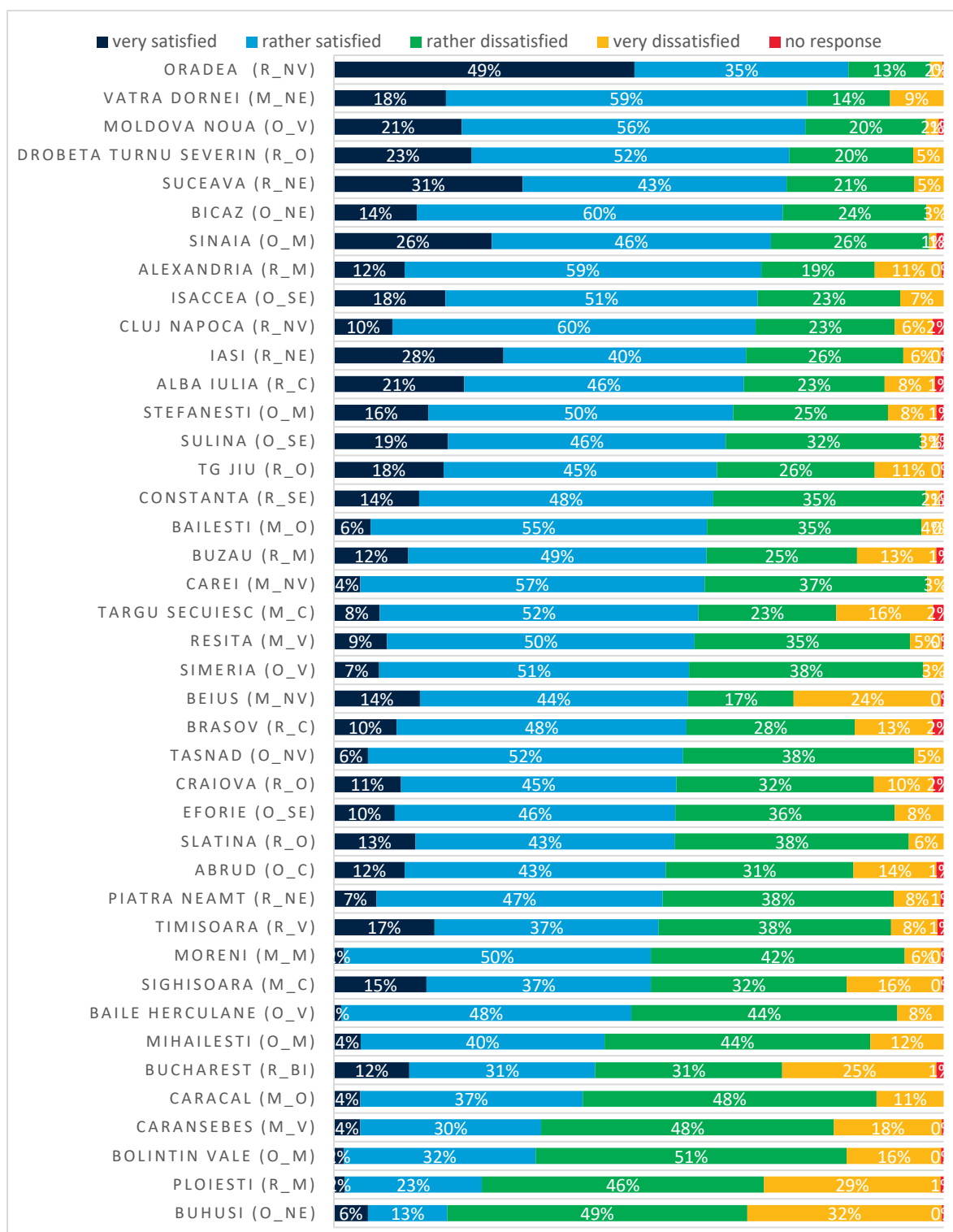
Figure 14. Central area of Craiova



Source: the authors, support map provided by Open Street Maps.

The satisfaction degree of Craiova's inhabitants regarding the condition of public spaces in their city, analyzed as part of the Urban Barometer carried out within the Romania's Urban Policy development project, indicated that **56% of the respondents are very satisfied or rather satisfied**, but in the hierarchy of the analyzed cities, Craiova City ranks 26th out of 41, 10% of the respondents declaring themselves very dissatisfied.

Figure 15. How satisfied are you with the condition of the buildings in your city... [your city]? – a comparison



Source: Romania's Urban Policy, Quality of Life Barometer 2020.

INTEGRATED URBAN REGENERATION OF NEIGHBORHOODS

Analysis of the attractiveness of the neighborhoods in Craiova and its peri-urban area

The structure of the neighborhoods in Craiova City and its peri-urban area can be divided into:

- 1) The **central zone**, which concentrates the main cultural, historical and representative public spaces of the city, around which there are both low-rise housing units as well as collective housing buildings dating from the socialist period.
- 2) **Collective housing neighborhoods** - George Enescu, Craiovița Nouă, Brazda lui Novac, Piața Gării, Rovine, Sărari, 1 Mai, Lăpuș Argeș, Valea Roșie, which are usually well served by public facilities, but the quality of life is affected by the overcrowding of the public space by parked cars and the insufficient number of spaces for recreation and socialization in the vicinity of the house.
- 3) **(Old) low-rise urban neighborhoods** - Știrbei Vodă, Brestei, Siloz, Ungureni, Cernele, Craiovița Veche, Nisipuri Dorobăntia, Severinului, Fața Luncii, Lascăr Catargiu, Mofleni, Popoveni, Romanesti, Dunării, with a very dense urban fabric and where the quality of housing and the degree of neighborhood facilities coverage varies. Here and there, the quality of transport / pedestrian / technical-urban / social infrastructure is poor, making these neighborhoods difficult to cross on foot. While some neighborhoods are close to the central area or are well connected to the public transport network, others are located at a significant distance from the center and are difficult to reach without a car.
- 4) **Newly developed neighborhoods on the outskirts of the city**, both within the territorial administrative limits - the Veteranilor, Hipodrom, Bordei, Plaiul Vulcănești, Bariera Vâlcii neighborhoods, as well as in the localities in the south and east of the peri-urban ring - Valea Fetii, Preajba Nouă, Banu Mărăcine. These neighborhoods usually consist of single-family homes or low height regime buildings, have a high degree of fragmentation in the development of plots and have deficiencies in terms of technical-urban and transport infrastructure - both unpaved streets, missing sidewalks and lack of metropolitan public transport lines, basic social infrastructure - schools, health care facilities, but also in terms of the access to public spaces and neighborhood facilities - playgrounds, socializing areas, proximity stores.
- 5) **Dependent villages** - Făcăi, Mofleni, Popoveni, Șimnicu de Jos, Cernele, Cernele de Sus, Rovine, Izvoru Rece, small settlements, located at the border between the TAU and the peri-urban localities. The main objectives for these areas are to facilitate fair access to the basic - technical-urban and social infrastructure and a more efficient connection with the central area, to connect the inhabitants to the main attractions, be they employers, commercial spaces, cultural and leisure areas, etc.

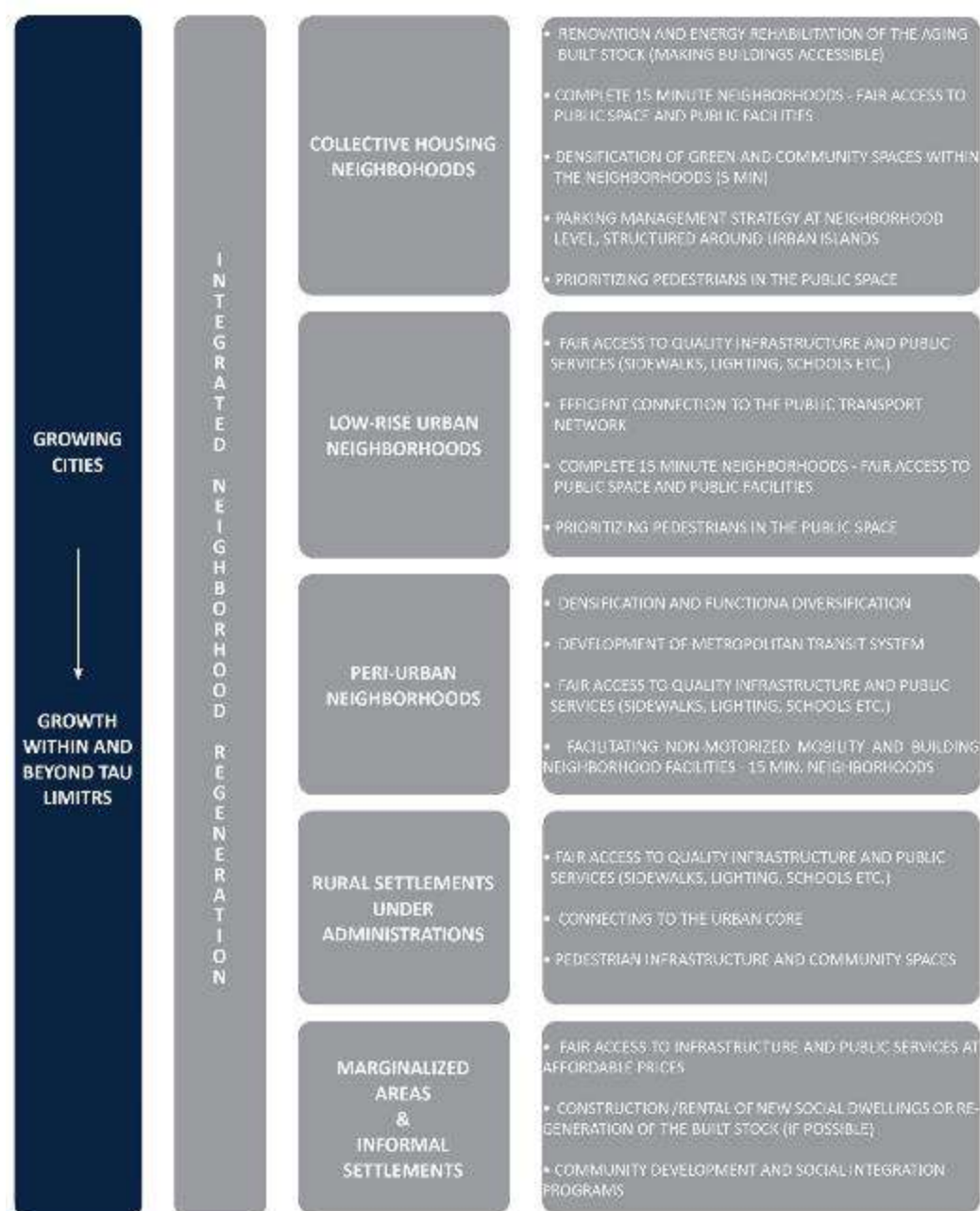
The complex structure of Craiova City requires urban regeneration programs adapted to each type of neighborhood, and the implementation must be done in an integrated way both at the level of the neighborhood or neighborhood unit, and at the level of the development directions, by coordinating regeneration projects with those covering mobility and infrastructure. An integrated and adapted approach will increase the attractiveness of both old and newly developed neighborhoods, thus reducing unjustified land consumption and the uncontrolled urban expansion.

In order to reduce dependence on the car in the pursuit of the goal of achieving green and resilient cities, it is important to analyze the location of housing areas relative to the main mobility corridors which connect them to other functional areas of the city. The prioritization process must aim at ensuring fair access to public transport by expanding the transport network, streamlining the existing transport lines and increasing the frequency, so that public transport becomes a reliable means of transport. At the same time, pedestrian accessibility must be improved, through infrastructure interventions in poor areas and the management of parking spaces in dense neighborhoods of collective housing, so that travel is safe and comfortable.

Access to neighborhood facilities in the vicinity of homes contributes to increasing the quality of life in neighborhoods, and urban regeneration of neighborhoods following the principles of complementarity and neighborhood units will help reduce car dependence by providing the necessary facilities for daily life at a comfortable walking distance. For the new neighborhoods in peri-urban areas, which often do not have the necessary infrastructure, a priority is to expand and improve the quality of streets, sidewalks and to build schools and neighborhood facilities.

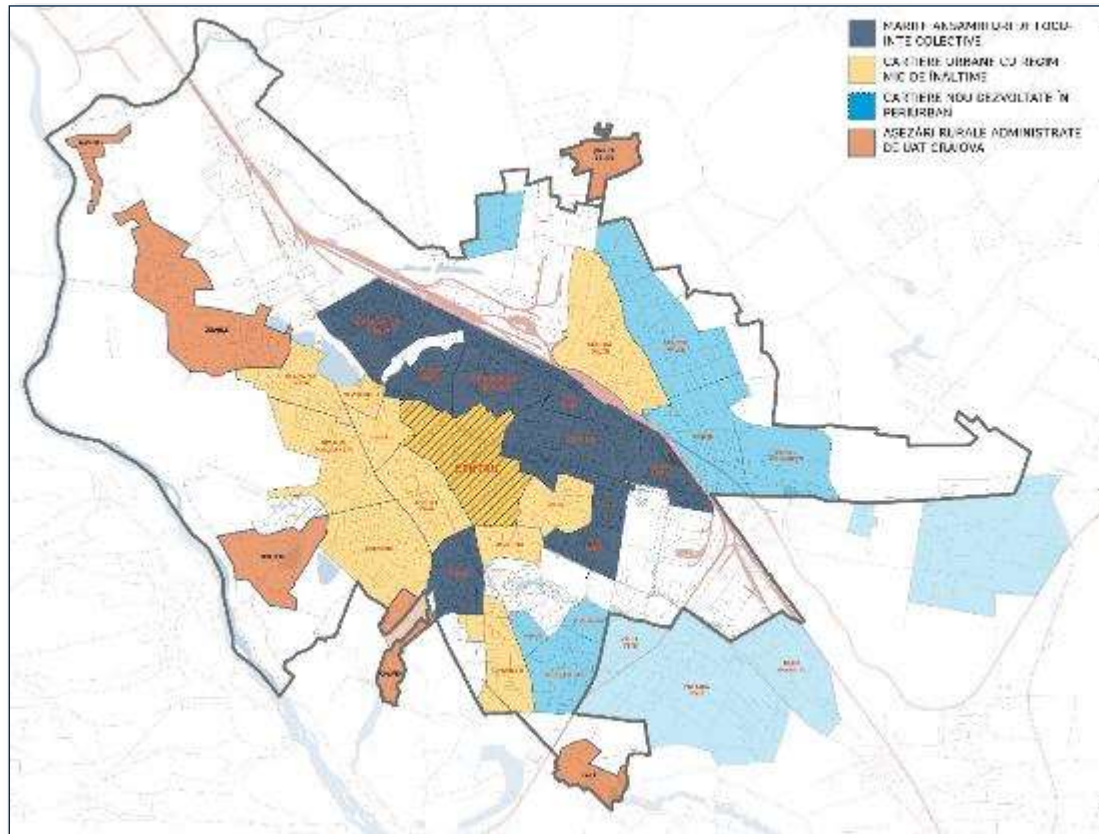
Integrated rehabilitation of apartment buildings from the socialist period in terms of the building, the neighborhood and the levels of intervention (energy efficiency, architecture and structure) will contribute the quality of public space and housing, making these neighborhoods and buildings competitive options for housing. Particular attention must be paid to the accessibility of residential buildings, both to ensure easy access for people with disabilities, those with strollers and the elderly, encouraging a more active lifestyle and involvement in the community.

Figure 16. Urban regeneration measures for neighborhoods in dynamic cities.



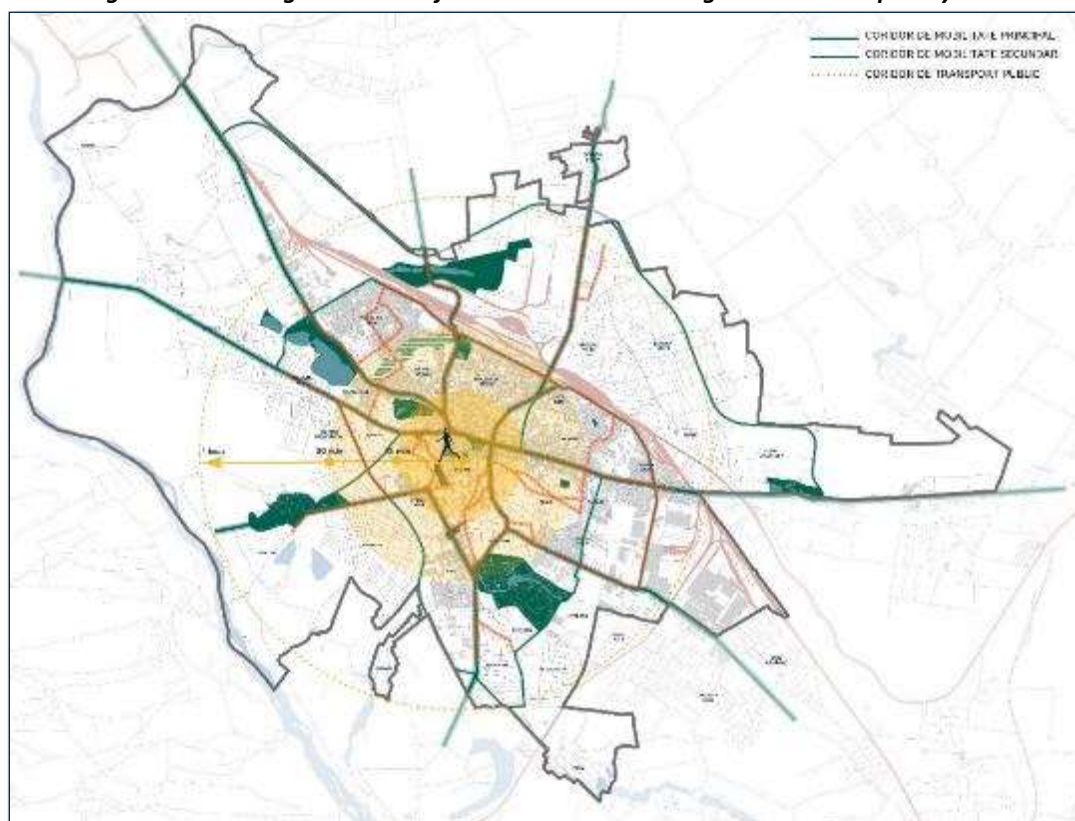
Source: The authors.

Figure 17. The structure of Craiova by typology of the neighborhoods.



Source: The authors.

Figure 18. The neighborhoods of Craiova relative to the green and transport system.



Source: The authors.

Legend:

- BLOOUR: TERMIZOLATS IN TOTALITE
- BLOOUR: TERMIZOLATS PARTIAL
- BLOOUR: NEZOLATE

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Figure 21. Analysis of urban island dimensions in Craiova City



Source: Space Syntax for IUDS Craiova - Annex 2.

Figure 22. Analysis of the degree of accessibility of streets in Craiova City - the integrated situation.



Source: Space Syntax for IUDS Craiova - Annex 1.

Table 4 Condition of the infrastructure and degree of coverage of the facilities in Craiova neighborhoods¹²

Typology	Neighborhood	Pedestrian infrastructure	Connections with attractions	Social infrastructure	Public spaces
Mixed urban fabric	Center	++	++	++	++
Collective housing	Craiovița Nouă	-/+	++	++	-/+
	George Enescu	+/-	++	++	++
	Brazda lui Novac	+/-	+	++	-/+
	Piața Gării	+/-	++	++	-/+
	Rovine	+/-	+	++	+/-
	Sărari	-/+	+	+/-	-/+
	Lăpuș Argeș	-/+	++	+	--
	1 Mai	-/+	++	+	+/-
Low-rise housing	Știrbei Vodă	-/+	++	+/-	+/-
	Breștei	-/+	++	+/-	++
	Craiovița Veche	--	+/-	--	--
	Romanescu	--	+/-	-/+	+/-
	Nisipuri Dorobănția	--	+/-	--	-/+
	Catargiu	--	-/+	-/+	-/+
	Ungureni	+/-	++	-/+	--
	Siloz	+/-	++	-/+	+/-
	Valea Roșie	-/+	-/+	+	-/+
	Bariera Vâlcii	--	-/+	--	--
New neighborhoods in the peri-urban area	Bariera Vâlcii	--	--	--	--
	Bordei	--	-/+	--	--
	Plaiul Vulcănești	--	--	--	+
	Valea Fetii	--	--	--	--
	Preajba Nouă	--	--	--	--
	Banu Mărăcine	--	--	--	--
	Veteranilor	--	-/+	-/+	--
	Hipodrom	+/-	+	--	+
	Valea Șarpelui	--	-/+	--	+/-
Rural settlements under the administration of Craiova TAU	Airport	--	--	--	--
	Cernele	--	-/+	-/+	--
	Izvorul Rece	--	--	--	--
	Mofleni	-/+	+/-	--	+/-
	Popoveni	--	--	--	--
	Făcăi	--	--	--	--
	Șimnicu de Jos	--	+/-	--	--

Source: The authors, based on the situational analysis.

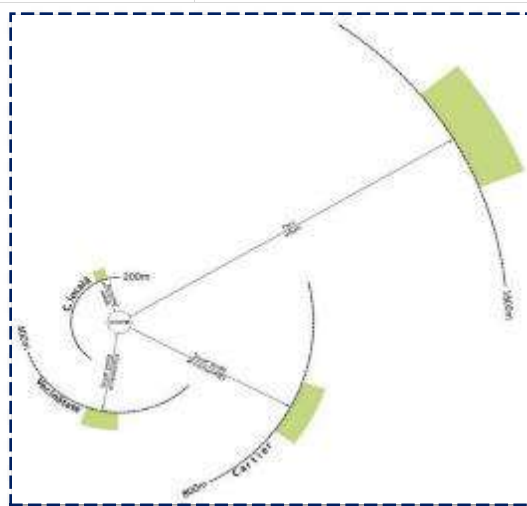
¹²LEGEND: ++ very good condition/coverage, + good condition/coverage +/- satisfactory condition/coverage, -/+ unsatisfactory condition of the facilities, the facilities do not exist, but there is potential, unsatisfactory streets or pedestrian infrastructure, -- the facilities do not exist/unpaved streets and no sidewalks.

Good practices for the regeneration of the public space in collective housing neighborhoods

The process aimed at regenerating large housing compounds and prioritizing interventions requires a staged and structured approach around the intervention at different urban scales (neighborhood → neighborhood unit → urban island). The table below summarizes the measures and objectives proposed in the *Urban Regeneration Guide* for large collective housing compounds, developed by the World Bank.¹³

Table 5 Measures proposed for the regeneration of apartment building neighborhoods.

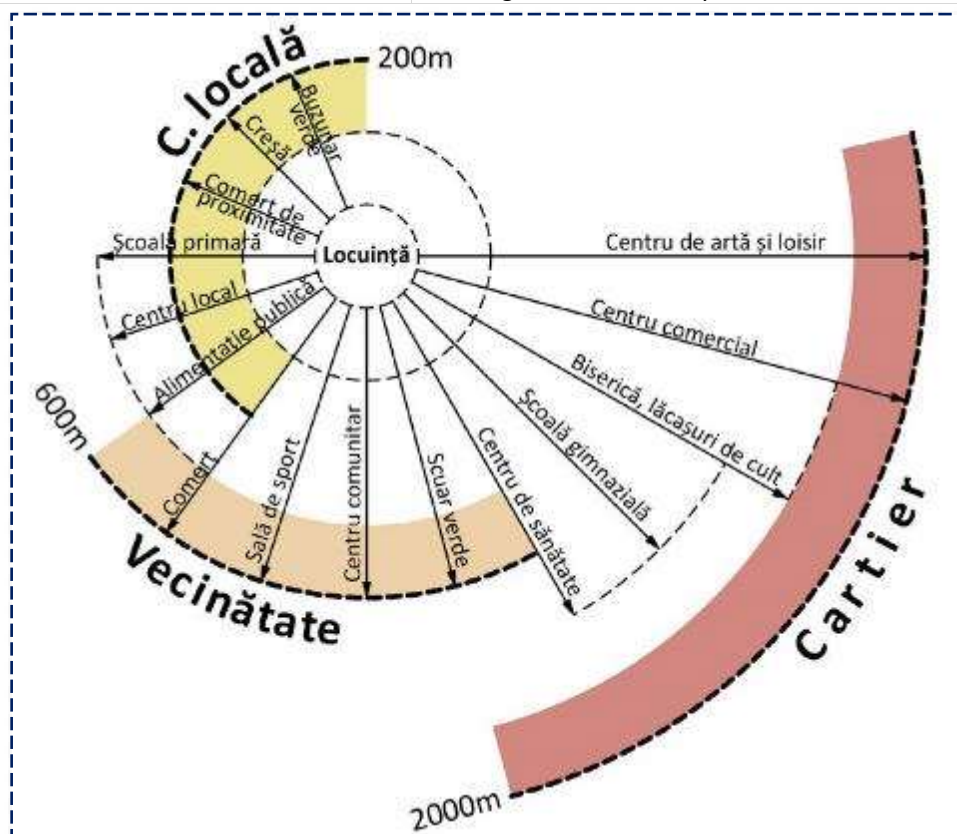
Objective	Measures
STAGE 1. Strengthening an integrated green system and facilitating fair access to green public spaces in the vicinity of the home. <u>Particularities of the apartment building neighborhoods</u>: significant areas planted with trees and shrubs, located between the housing units, which are usually not developed or accessible, but can be used as green spaces and invested with additional features (playground, urban furniture for socializing activities, etc.) and thus can contribute to ensuring the necessary green space and facilities at the neighborhood level. <u>Features of peri-urban neighborhoods</u>: possibility of developing unused lands in public-private partnership. <u>Features of individual housing neighborhoods</u>: although there are limitations regarding land resources here, there is a possibility to carry out temporary interventions on vacant spaces and to reconfigure the green mobility corridors.	Identifying and capitalizing on various types of public green spaces - Green pocket (S = 0.01 ha - 1 ha) 200 m away from the house (2.5 min.) - Green square of the “neighborhood” (S = 1 ha - 6 ha) 400 m away from the house (5 min.) - Green square of the “community” (S = 6 ha - 8 ha) 800 m away from the house (10 min.) - Urban park (S = 18 ha - 200 ha) = 1600 m (20 min.) away from the house - Natural park / forest park (S > 200 ha) = 3200 m away from the house Identification of ecological corridors and integration of green spaces in an integrated system: - Category I and II streets allow the reconfiguration of the street profile and the introduction of new ecological elements - tree alignment, green surfaces acting as biofilter, patches of spontaneous habitat, conducive to facilitating non-motorized mobility, especially pedestrian access. Capitalization of inaccessible green spaces between apartment buildings, vacant lots or vacant spaces, in the form of green pockets, invested with additional functionalities, that directly respond to the needs of the local community, while pursuing the complementarity of activities and covering the needs of all age groups



¹³ The World Bank, Urban Regeneration Guide, June 2020.

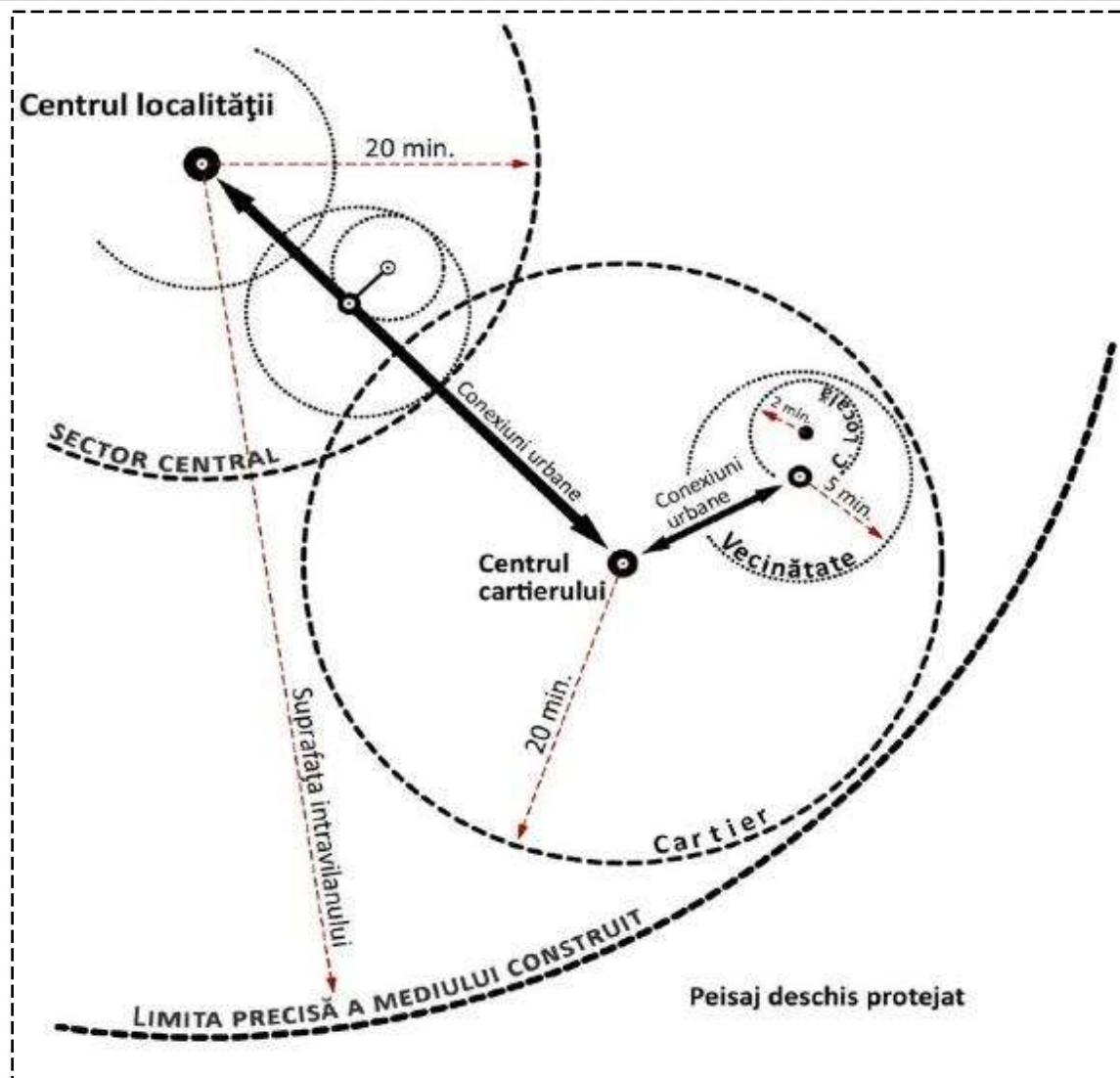
STAGE 2.1.
**Structural and functional reorganization of
the neighborhood around neighborhood
centers.**

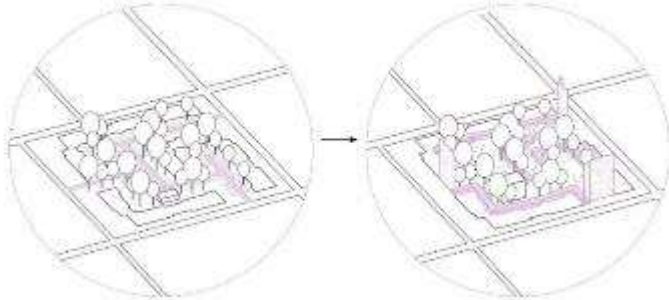
1. **Identifying the need for public facilities**, depending on no. of inhabitants and existing facilities.
 - Local communities 150-250 m
 - primary school (2,500-4,000 inhabitants)
 - family doctor (2,500-3,000 inhabitants)
 - proximity shop (2,000-5,000 inhabitants)
 - Neighborhood units 400-600 m
 - community office spaces (7,500 inhabitants)
 - community center (7,000 - 15,000 inhabitants)
 - restaurant services (5,000 - 7,000 inhabitants)
 - local administration (5,000 - 10,000 inhabitants)
 - Neighborhood 2 - 6 km
 - sports center (25,000 - 40,000 inhabitants)
 - neighborhood center (25,000 - 40,000 inhabitants)
 - library (12,000 - 30,000 inhabitants)
 - health center (9,000 - 12,000 inhabitants)
2. **Designing neighborhood centers** with recreational functions for all age groups (youth center, senior club), cultural centers (cinema, art gallery)
3. **Using school (court) sports facilities as community spaces**, outside school hours, to increase access to sports fields.
4. **Functional reconversion of the ground floors of the apartment buildings** located on streets with a high degree of accessibility.



STAGE 2.2
Defining urban communities within which to ensure pedestrian access to community services and facilities.

1. **Applying the concept of a 15-20 minute neighborhood** in identifying priority regeneration areas, starting from key elements of their operation, such as the public transport system. Neighborhoods can be identified by:
 - morphology - the large housing compounds dating from the socialist period were designed as a neighborhood
 - population - the neighborhood usually concentrates a community of 25,000-50,000 people
 - readability - identification of development *clusters* in destructured residential areas
2. **Structural reorganization of the neighborhood around hierarchical urban communities**, each scale playing a different role for the urban community.
 - *Neighborhood unit*: service radius of 400 m, 5 min walk, 5,000-10,000 inhabitants
 - *Local urban community*: service radius of 200 m, 2 min walk, 2,000-3,000 inhabitants
3. **Facilitating pedestrian mobility and urban connections** inside neighborhood units, but also between them and the means of public transport.



STAGE 3. Configuring urban islands within the neighborhoods where to take the following actions: 1. Reorganizing residential parking lots and prioritizing pedestrian traffic. 2. Prioritizing and developing the open space, with functions for the community.	Defining urban islands within apartment building neighborhoods by analyzing the existing readability at the neighborhood level, identifying the open spaces between the buildings and the groups of buildings that delimit them. In large collective compounds, buildings are often arranged in such a way that they clearly define a semi-enclosed space, similar to an inner courtyard.
STAGE 3.1. Management of residential car parking around urban islands General principles of parking management in large residential buildings compounds: • closing traffic inside the urban island and arranging parking lots in its perimeter area • redirecting residential parking lots along the main streets, parallel to the direction of travel or in underground, above-ground garages, in a composite system. 	Approach 1. Recovering the space inside the urban island from its use as a parking space and establishing parking alternatives in the perimeter of the urban island, along the streets. Approach 2. Building underground or semi-buried car parking lots over which public spaces can be developed (e.g. sports fields). Approach 3. Building multi-story park lots on certain vacant lands or vacated following the decommissioning of individual garages. In order to be compatible with the perspective of a green future, in which non-motorized mobility and public transport prevail, but also to make a positive contribution on the local community, the multi-story structures intended to be used as parking lots must be conceived by taking into account the following directions: • inclusion of community spaces (e.g. rooftop sports field) and mixed ground functions on the ground floor of buildings • multifunctionality and adaptability of spaces (e.g. higher clear heights of floors, to be later invested with public functions) • interesting facades, which create a pleasant environment and a quality public space (e.g. green facades, street/mural art, etc.)
STAGE 3.2. Prioritization of the open space inside urban islands	Structuring and organizing the space determined by the urban islands, according to a public-private hierarchy, in order to decompose the macro scale at which the buildings and the space between them were originally designed and to free them from the overcrowding by parked cars. The space delimited by groups of buildings can be invested with public functions, oriented towards the local community (200 m), thus defining secondary neighborhood centers.
	

Source: Urban Regeneration Guide - Large housing compounds, World Bank, 2020.

Regeneration opportunities in collective housing neighborhoods

Regeneration actions must aim to reduce the dominance of the car and to prioritize non-motorized travel, the common challenge of collective housing neighborhoods being the suffocation of public space by parked cars and the lack of attention to pedestrian comfort and community spaces. Large collective housing compounds are complex neighborhoods which require an integrated approach, which can be most effectively achieved by developing master plans at the neighborhood level, to develop diagnostic analysis and identify key challenges and opportunities.

- **Complex interventions that require coordination plans - reconfiguring parking lots and open spaces around urban islands.** The degree of permeability of the urban fabric and implicitly the size of the urban islands influence the quality of the public space - a permeable area, with small urban islands, creating an environment conducive to pedestrian traffic. In Craiova City, the permeability degree is higher in the central area and in the apartment building neighborhoods, while the areas of new or old houses have a lower degree of permeability. Possible interventions around urban islands include: reconfiguring parking spaces to their outer limits and in multi-story parking lots to recover community spaces, capitalizing on green spaces and open spaces inside the island, reconfiguring local streets as shared spaces, allocating complementary functions to the recovered spaces to serve the local community or to form neighborhood sub-centers, rehabilitation of playgrounds and existing urban furniture.
- **Common lines of action to bring specific improvements of the quality of life in neighborhoods**, which can become local government programs:
 - **developing schoolyards** so that they serve the local community outside of school hours, as playgrounds or sports facilities.
 - **capitalization of streets as line-like public spaces:**
 - streets with a high degree of accessibility - capitalizing on the economic and community potential,
 - local service streets - reconfiguration as shared public spaces.
 - **capitalizing on open spaces and their repurposing with public facilities** - playgrounds, sports fields, socializing spaces for various interests, etc.
 - nodes with a high degree of accessibility (e.g. squares),
 - green, inaccessible spaces with spontaneous vegetation, around apartment buildings,
 - vacant lots or other spaces recovered from the reconfiguration of parking lots.

Figure 23. Gran via de Ferran el Catolic, Valencia - Regeneration of a main mobility corridor as a line-like public space.



Source: Space Syntax for IUDS Craiova - Annex 2.

Table 6 Regeneration opportunities in collective housing neighborhoods in Craiova City.

Areas with regeneration potential	Urban islands with reconfiguration potential
<u>ROVINE NEIGHBORHOOD - GĂRII SQUARE</u> Highly accessible streets • Vasile Alecsandri Str., Nanterre Str. • Dezrobirii Str., Horia Str. • Spania Str. – Petre Ispirescu Str. • Gogu Constantinescu Str., Dacia Blvd. • Frații Golești Str. - segment between Vasile Alecsandri Str. and Alexandru Ioan Cuza Str. • Nicolae Iorga Str. - segment between Dezrobirii Str. and Gogu Constantinescu Str. • Traian Lalescu Str. - segment between Gogu Constantinescu Str. and Dezrobirii Str. Schools whose courtyards could be capitalized on: • Nicolae Bălcescu Junior High School • Matei Basarab High School • Queen Elizabeth Sanitary Post-secondary School • Gheorghe Țițeica Junior High School • Tudor Arghezi Theoretical High School Highly accessible nodes: • Horia Str. - between apartment buildings P4, A7 • Velovan Str. and Petre Ispirescu Str. • George Fotino Str. and Arhitect Ion Mincu Str. • Nicolae Iorga Blvd. and Nicolae Iorga Alley • Rovine Garden - between apartment buildings E7, E12 • Railway station / Bus terminal North (Nicovalei Str.) • Constantin Brâncuși Square (Dacia Blvd.) • Dacia Blvd. (in front of apartment building 63)	N. Iorga Str. – N. Iorga Alley – Buciumului Str.  N. Iorga Str. – Traian Lalescu Str. – Dezrobirii Str.  Basarabia Str. – Maramureșului Str. – Bucovina Str. 
<u>GEORGE ENESCU NEIGHBORHOOD</u> Highly accessible nodes • Nicolae Titulescu Blvd. and Amaradia Str. • Nicoale Titulescu Blvd. - Maria Tănase Str. – Pascani Str. Schools whose courtyards could be capitalized on • Energetics Technical College • Decebal Junior High School	Pașcani Str. – Dâmbovița Str. – George Enescu Str. 

BRAZDA LUI NOVAC NEIGHBORHOOD

Highly accessible streets

- Brazda lui Novac Str., Doljului Str.
- 1 Decembrie 1918 Str.
- General Constantin Argetoianu Str.
- General Dr. Ion Cernătescu Str. (between Privighetoarei Str. and General Constantin Argetoianu Str.)

Schools whose courtyards could be capitalized on

- Sfântul Gheorghe Junior High School
- School No. 23
- Terraveda Junior High School
- Ștefan Velovan National College
- C. Brâncuși Technical College of Arts and Crafts
- Railway - Transport Technical High School

Highly accessible nodes

- Sergeant Constantin Popescu Str. and General Dr. Ion Cernătescu Str.
- Brazda lui Novac Str. and Mareșal Alexandru Averescu Str.
- Lămâiței Str. and Sergeant Constantin Popescu Str.

Gr. Ștefan Fălcoianu Str. – Brazda lui Novac Str. – Gr. Nicolae Măgureanu Str.



Brazda lui Novac Str. – Dacia Blvd. – Frații Golești Str.



CRAIOVITA NOUĂ NEIGHBORHOOD

Highly accessible streets

- Bd. Oltenia
- Str. George Enescu
- Str. Elena Farago (N. De Bd. Oltenia)
- Alea Arh. Duiliu Marcu – spațiu verde

Schools whose courtyards could be capitalized on

- Liceul Tehnic George Bibescu
- Școala Gimnazială Alexandru Macedonski
- Școala Gimnazială Elena Farago
- Școala Gimnazială Mihai Viteazul

Highly accessible nodes

- Pe Bd. Oltenia la intersecția cu Bd. Tineretului, Str. Castanilor, Alea Castanilor, Str. Frații Bobescu, Str. Elena Farago (bloc 128 B), Alea Arh. Duiliu Marcu (nr. 12 - bl. 9, 9A, 26A)
- Str. George Enescu și Alea Arh. Duiliu Marcu
- Str. Castanilor și Alea Castanilor
- Str. Castanilor și Str. Nicolae Coculescu

Bd. Tineretului – Bd. Oltenia - Alea Arh. Duiliu Marcu



Bd. Dacia – Bd. Oltenia – Str. Gorunului



1 MAI NEIGHBORHOOD

Highly accessible streets

- Dr. Ion Cantacuzino Str. (E of V. Gomoiu Str.)
- Popoveni Str. (between Constantin Angelescu Str. and Mihai Cănciulescu Str.)

Schools whose courtyards could be capitalized on

- Gheorghe Bibescu Junior High School
- Gheorghe Chitu National Economic College

Highly accessible nodes

- Dr. Ion Cantacuzino Str. – Dr. Victor Gomoiu Str. – Dr. Ștefan Berceanu Str.
- Dr. Victor Gomoiu Str. – Dr. Nicolae C. Păulescu Str.
- Dr. Victor Gomoiu Str. – Popoveni Str.
- Dr. Nicolae Ionescu Sisești Str. – Dr. Ion Cantacuzino Str.

Dr. Ion Cantacuzino Str. – Dr. Victor Gomoiu Str. –
Popoveni Str. – Constantin Angelescu Str.



VALEA ROȘIE NEIGHBORHOOD

Highly accessible streets

- Henri Coandă Str. (between Împ. Traian Str. and I.D. Sârbu Str.)
- Pandurilor Str.
- 22 Decembrie 1989 Str. (S of I.D. Sârbu Str.)
- I.D. Sârbu Str.
- Revoluției Str.
- Vântului Str.

Schools whose courtyards could be capitalized on

- Ștefan Odobleja College
- Nicolae Romanescu Junior High School
- Theodor Aman Junior High School

Highly accessible nodes

- I.D. Sârbu Str. (between 22 Decembrie 1989 Str. and Henri Coandă Str.)
- Revoluției Str. (between Vântului Str. and Revoluției Str.)
- Rovinari Str. and Împăratul Traian Str.
- Agri-Food Market (Profi)
- Vântului Str. - Aurel Vlaicu Str. – Revoluției Str.
- I.D. Sârbu Str. – Pandurilor Str.

Revoluției Str. – Caracal Str. – 22 Decembrie 1989 Str.



Capitalization potential - neighborhood subcenter



LĂPUȘ ARGES NEIGHBORHOOD

Schools whose courtyards could be capitalized on

- Mihai Eminescu Junior High School
- Auto Technological High School
- Electrotechnics Campus

Highly accessible streets and nodes

- Calea București and Decebal Blvd.
- Grigore Pleșoianu Str.
- Eustațiu Stoenescu Str.

Urban islands around the Electroputere passage



SĂRARI NEIGHBORHOOD

Highly accessible streets

- Str. Spania, Str. Nanterre
- Str. Împăratul Traian

Schools whose courtyards could be capitalized on

- Liceul Teoretic Henri Coandă
- Liceul Tehnologic UCECOM Spiru Haret

Highly accessible nodes

- Str. Runcu și Str. Electroputere
- Str. Ludovic Mrazec și Str. Electroputere
- Str. Sărarilor nr. 41

Potential to regenerate the open spaces within the urban islands (blocks)



Urban regeneration proposals in neighborhoods

In preparing the urban regeneration projects in Craiova, the public administration analyzed the field needs of the neighborhoods, a process that resulted in the following project proposals.

Table 7. Proposals of the public administration for the urban regeneration of the neighborhoods

BARIERA VÂLCII NEIGHBORHOOD

Delimitation: Calea București - northern bypass - Alea IV Șimnic - railway

Țuculescu School

- Demolition of old school buildings
- Extension and modernization of the main school body
- New body building to include: classrooms, library, after-school, medical offices
- Gym extension
- Rehabilitation and endowment of the central heating building + the thermal network for the whole complex
- Fencing
- School and kindergarten arrangement
- Video cameras + Wi-Fi + smart lighting

Kindergarden on Str. Teilor (structure of the Țuculescu School)

- Demolition / reconstruction for the construction of the NS corridor road bridge
- Reconfiguration of the intersection Str. Teilor with Str. FALL
- Arrangement of a playground for children in kindergarten
- parking
- Video cameras + Wi-Fi + smart lighting
- Fencing

Kindergarten no. 5 – Îngerașii (Șimnic)

- Demolition of bodies
- Construction: nursery, kindergarten, school, after-school
- Gym and sports field
- Fencing
- Yard arrangement
- Playgrounds
- Video cameras, Wi-Fi, smart lighting

Valea Șarpelui

- Closure of landfill and greening area
- Park arrangement + access roads to the park and Balta Tancodrom: Aleea I Șimnic (half is owned by CET) and connecting road between Bariera Vâlcii and Aleea IV Șimnic

N-S Mobility Corridor

- Express road and the intersection with Str. Toameni (up to the train station) which also includes the above-ground road bridge, the arrangement of the intersection of Str. Carpenului with Str. Mălinului and arrangement of the intersection of Str. Toamnei with Str. Lindens
- Hobbed bridge over the CFR network
- Modernization of streets and alleys in the Bariera Vâlcii neighborhood
- Reconfiguration of the intersection Str. Toamnei with Bâera Vâlcii and Str. Vineyards (walkway)
- Continue traffic corridor Str. Mălinului, Str. Carpenului, Drumul Ungurenilor, Pescărușului to Calea București
- To be identified for the construction / arrangement of a socio-medical center (possible at the end of the Bălcești Road route, at the exit from Șimnicu de Jos)

Challenges and proposals

- Lack of shopping area (supermarket / hypermarket)
- Lack of systematization of the street network
- Lack of rainwater drainage system - Proposal: arrangement of the neighborhood rainwater network
- To analyze the household network on all alleys
- Identify streets where there is no gas network
- Extension of public lighting
- Urban furniture
- Incinerator land Aleea I Șimnic - Proposal: social medical center on this land

BRAZDA LUI NOVAC NEIGHBORHOOD

Delimitation: Bvd. Dacia, Str. Frații Golești, Str. Păltiniș, Str. Șerban Vodă, Str. Novac's furrow, Str. Amaradia

Challenges, opportunities and regeneration proposals in the neighborhood

- Str. Lămăiței, opposite Block 31 - land suitable for a playground / park
 - Neighborhood space for blocks 18 and 19, land suitable for parking
 - The space in front of the block BB ' - proposal to reposition the playground to Str. Remus and construction of multi-story car park
 - The area in front of the A6 block (Baba Novac) - parking arrangement proposal
 - The area opposite the Little House Kindergarten with stories, behind the place where the dumpsters are located - parking proposal
 - The area behind the D31 block, behind the Polyclinic (where the gas pipeline is located) - redevelopment proposal
 - Polyclinic rehabilitation? (to clarify the legal regime - Heritage Department and Public Services Department)
 - Neighborhood space for blocks D24, F9 and E5 very generous, possibly suitable for parking
 - Expropriation proposal if not public domain
 - Between blocks D24 and D23 there is a degraded private land - expropriation and redevelopment proposal
 - Land blocks F6, D18 and BIG - parking arrangement proposal
-

- The land behind the F5 wool block BIG, in front of the L1 block, staircase 1 and the D15 block - to clarify the legal regime
- School no. 24 - redevelopment of the yard and creation of a sports base for the neighborhood
- Reconfigure the intersection Str. Doljului with Str. December 1, 1918
- Reconfigure the intersection Str. Doljului with Str. Novac's furrow
- Reconfigure the intersection Str. Făgăraș with Str. Amaradia
- Reconfigure intersection Str. The Golesti Brothers with Bvd. Dacia and the Vâlcii Barrier
- (Citizens proposal) Pedestrian space in the neighborhood of blocks 18 and 19, space suffocated by cars and where dumpsters are currently located

CRAIOVIȚA NOUĂ NEIGHBORHOOD

Delimitation: Calea Severinului, Bvd. Dacia, Str. Amaradia, Str. Nicolae Titulescu, Calea Severinului

Proposals, opportunities and regeneration proposals in the neighborhood

- Str. Frații Bobescu, block area 44 - multi-storey parking proposal
- Rehabilitated / modernized bus stations
- Thermal rehabilitation of blocks
- Large parking lot opposite School no. 30 existing - proposal for underground / above-ground parking
- The artesian well in front of School no. 30 - proposal for demolition and redevelopment of the pedestrian and recreation area
- The alley to the left of the artesian well - redevelopment proposal and facilities for the elderly (fitness equipment, pergolas, backgammon tables, chess, etc.)
- Rehabilitation of pedestrian esplanade between the Cathedral and the Horizon
- Alley to school no. 30 - abolition of parking for the smart pedestrian area
- School workshop building no. 30 - rehabilitation + change of destination
- In front of the Blue Flower Kindergarten - proposal for arranging a sports base for the neighborhood
- The area between Blue Flower Kindergarten and block 19 - multi-storey parking arrangement with playground above
- Rehabilitation and painting of thermal points
- Underground cable relocation
- Redevelopment of the park in the area behind the BIG Craiovița Noua Church
- Relocation of the playground from the Post Office - BIG in the perimeter behind the Church and parking parking given the positioning at the main street, respectively Tineretului street
- Elena Farago School - has a very generous field and it is proposed to rearrange it as a semi-open sports base (with a dedicated program for the citizens of the neighborhood)
- PTCZ 254 Big Vechi thermal point - block 115 - parking arrangement
- Land between Rocadă and block 115B2 - entrance to Craiovița - Materna - small park redevelopment
- Surroundings Sunflower Kindergarten
- In the back of school no. 32 to Block 5A - parking + redevelopment area, playground, small park
- Area Block 10 Experimental - parking arrangement

Proposals for urban mobility interventions

- Realization of the tram line loop in front of Auchan Craiovița on the route Str. Tufănele - Bvd. Oltenia - Bvd. Tineretului - with exit to ANLs, with a dedicated lane for tram and bus
- Arranging a turn at the intersection of Str. Brâncoveanu with Str. George Enescu (Segarcea area) and widening Str. Constantin Brâncoveanu, section between Str. George Enescu and Bvd. Dacia
- Arrangement at the intersection of Str. George Enescu with Bvd. Tineretului (Post Office - Craiovița Nouă)
- Arrangement of the intersection of Str. Tufănele with Str. Ax (SIF Oltenia)
- Enlargement Str. Pașcani (section between Billa and Sineasca cemetery) with resistematization, the intersection of Str. Pașcani with Str. George Enescu and re-establishment Str. Muncitorului (between LIDL and the fence of Sineasca cemetery) to Str. Făgăraș by expropriation lands related to private properties
- Piercing Str. Rîului - Calea Severinului over Balta Craioviței

FĂCĂI NEIGHBORHOOD

Delimitation: (V) Craiova-Calafat railway line, (E) Str. Dorna, chain of lakes near, (S) main collector Craiova, (N) Str. Ialomiței, Str. Rarău, Str. mandrel

Challenges, opportunities and proposals for regeneration in the neighborhood:

- Social housing neighborhood
 - social housing blocks (2-3 blocks)
 - parking
 - playground + playground + fitness equipment + Wi-Fi
 - recreation and leisure area arrangement (chess, rummy, etc.) for the elderly
 - sports base for the neighborhood
 - smart lighting at school, kindergarten, playground, playground, recreation area + other Smart City elements
 - surveillance cameras for the entire neighborhood
- Extension of the existing school and its transformation into a gymnasium school (now it is a primary school)
- Kindergarten extension for nursery establishment
- Expansion of the natural gas network for the entire neighborhood
- Extension of the sewer and rainwater network for the entire neighborhood
- Modernization of streets in Făcăi neighborhood: Str. Harghita, Str. Ialomița, Str. Oltului, Str. Dorna, Str. Rarău, Str. Caraiman, Str. Tisa, Str. Bistriței, Str. Ciucaș, Str. Cindrel
- Arrangement of 2 pairs of SMART bus stations
- Arrangement of traffic collector street + bicycle tracks, in the northern area of Făcăi neighborhood to take over the traffic related to the streets: Harghita, Ialomița, Dorna
- Enlargement of Bechet Prolongation - railway line sector and administrative limit Craiova municipality (revision of the administration protocol of the National Company for Road Infrastructure Management)
- Făcăi railway underpass, at the level of 4 road lanes (in order to ensure the connection with the city)
- Drainage, drainage, collection and discharge of water from the swampy area (pond) located in the southern part of the neighborhood
- Creation of a traffic collector street + bicycle tracks in the southern area of the Făcăi neighborhood on the streets: Tisa, Bistriței, Ciucaș, Cindrel, adjacent to the collector canal
- Rehabilitation and extension of the canine shelter building and its transformation into a social service center for the population of the neighborhood (taxes and fees, population records, information center for citizens, medical services, veterinary services)

GARĂ - ROVINE NEIGHBORHOOD

Delimitation: Bvd. Carol- Gara-Str. Bucovina-Str. Nicolae Iorga- Str. Dezrobirii - Str. Petre Ispirescu - Bvd. Calea Bucuresti

Challenges:

- High traffic density and traffic systematization inadequate to the current traffic level, in the Station area
- Lack of a proper arrangement of the space afferent to the Station to serve the intermodal passenger transport
- The modal functions of public transport in the Station area are inhomogeneous and cannot ensure a quality intermodal transport
- Road connection between Dacia boulevard and bvd. Decebal, which must ensure a fluid traffic on the relationship Gara - South-East industrial platform is provided by 2 streets in pairs with one way, with significant bottlenecks caused by stationary traffic and the location of the agri-food market
- The area of the intersection of Nicolae Iorga street with Bucovina street is deficient from the point of view of traffic systematization (properly dimensioned roundabout, inadequate road signs)
- Between Nicolae Iorga street and Nicolae Julea street there is an unarranged vacant space with parking function, which needs refurbishment

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- Traffic congestion area at the intersection of Nicolae Iorga Street, Dezrobirii Street and Petre Ispirescu Street requires resistance and reconfiguration
 - The intersection of Traian Lalescu street with Dezrobirii street presents a high potential of traffic congestion, in the perspective of the bvd crossing. Calea Bucuresti, on the relation Str. Traian Lalescu - str. Henri Coanda
 - A general problem of the Rovine neighborhood consists in the following: the Rovine neighborhood is characterized as a neighborhood with a high density of residents and private cars, with a street plot undersized compared to current requirements and perspective, with major deficiencies in terms of properly systematized parking spaces
 - Also as a general problem of the neighborhood, as well as of all block neighborhoods in Craiova, there is the delimitation and closure of green spaces in the area of apartment buildings by metal fence and / or hedge and limiting access to residents of the neighborhood / city.

Proposals:

- Arranging an intermodal point in the Craiova Station area
- The widening of the street section on bvd. Dacia, between Gara and the intersection of bvd. Decebal with Titeica street
- Reconfiguration of the intersection of Nicolae Iorga street with Bucovina street, Pastorului street and Buciumului street
- Identification of land legal regime and arrangement of multi-storey parking on the vacant space identified between Nicolae Iorga street and Nicolae Julea street (behind Postei Rovine)
- Systematization of the intersection of Traian Lalescu street with Dezrobirii street and Petre Ispirescu street
- Identification of legal land regime and arrangement of multi-storey parking in the area of George Fotino Street and Stefan Velovan Street (former Maracana sports field, behind the former Parang shopping complex)
- Redevelopment of green spaces related to the blocks through the concept of "open and smart space" - without delimiting them by hedge / metal fence and endowment with smart elements: benches with photovoltaic panels to power the ports for charging devices: phones, tablets, laptops, system intelligent lighting with photovoltaic panels and presence sensors, mini-equipment for socialization by age categories)

PIAȚA VECHĂ NEIGHBORHOOD

Delimitation: Str. Nicolaescu Plopșor, Kogălniceanu, Unirii, Știrbei Vodă, Rîului, Știrbei Vodă, Câmpia Islaz, Libertății, Madona Dudu, Ion Maiorescu, Al Cuza

Challenges:

- Degraded Doljana artesian well
 - Lack of a connecting corridor between the restored Historic Center area and the Old Square area
 - Building with degraded historical value - Hotel Bucharest
 - Private land December 30 on which are permanently located cars, land and intersection not properly valued
 - The area of blocks of flats opposite the very crowded old square, with chaotic car parking, degraded thermal building and occupying a large percentage of the land belonging to the block of flats, area not properly developed
 - Intersection Mitropolie not properly valued
 - Degraded lip statue
 - Mitropolie park that needs redevelopment and proper capitalization of the entire land
 - Degraded Mercury walkway in need of refurbishment
 - The parking lot under the Mercury footbridge is insufficient and not properly arranged
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Proposals:

- Rehabilitation of Doljana artesian fountain
- Arranging a connecting corridor between the restored Historic Center area and the Old Square area
- Redevelopment of the intersection December 30 with the placement of a statue
- Arranging a parking lot in the block of flats opposite the old square
- Arrangement of the intersection of Sf. Dumitru with Str. Matei Basarab
- Rehabilitation of the Frații Buzești statue
- Redevelopment of the Metropolitan Park
- Arranging a suitable Mercury footbridge parking lot
- Arrangement of the intersection of Matei Basarab with Madona Dudu and Libertății
- Construction of a multi-storey car park on half of the Madona Dudu small park
- Reconfiguration of the intersection of Știrbei Voda with Câmpia Islaz and redevelopment of the artesian well area
- Purchase of land in front of the athletics stadium for above-ground parking
- Acquisition and rehabilitation of Puțureanu Inn
- Enlargement Str. Ion Maiorescu, Al Cuza and Mihai Viteazul with reconfiguration of intersections

SĂRARI NEIGHBORHOOD

Delimitation: Str. Putnei, Str. Spain, Str. Emperor Trajan, Str. Sărarilor, Str. Mircești, Str. Henri Coandă, Str. Putnei

Challenges, opportunities and proposals for regeneration in the neighborhood:

- Regeneration of the terrace of the M3 block, if the operating regime and the legislation allow it
- Area Bl. M11, Str. Mircești - mixed land (green area + parking) with the possibility of arranging above-ground parking
- Area Str. Vasilescu Carpen and Str. Ludovic Mrazec - mixed-function area (parking + green area) that can be arranged as above-ground parking
- Area related to the block of flats M48, M49, M52 (behind the Luceafărul Bookstore) - mixed land (unarranged playground + parking) with the potential to arrange a multi-storey car park with a playground above !! to identify legal regime playground !!
- Area Str. Emperor Trajan, Str. Henri Coandă, opposite the Church from Sărari, next to UCECOM, there are several garages on the public domain, with the potential to arrange parking lots
- Reconfiguration of the intersection Str. Henri Coandă with Str. Mircești
- Reconfiguration of the intersection Str. Henri Coandă with Str. Emperor Trajan (with magnification)
- Reconfiguration of the intersection Str. Emperor Trajan, Str. Spain, Str. General Magheru and Str. Rovinari (with increase in rotation)
- Possibility to purchase Electroputere Stadium for arranging multilevel parking + sports field / playground above

UNIVERSITATE NEIGHBORHOOD

Delimitation: Str. Emperor Trajan, Str. Nicolae Bălcescu, Calea București, Bvd. Carol I, Str. ARIEȘ

Challenges:

- To clarify the situation of the CAO water basin (construction + land) legal regime, functionality and the possibility of their demolition and capitalization of the land for landscaping parks + green areas + parking lots
 - Children's polyclinic? To identify the owner, functionality and the possibility of purchase / demolition for capitalization of construction and land + green facades
 - Thermal points buildings (behind the Patria cinema + Court) - to be rehabilitated or demolished
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Proposals:

- Above-ground passage over Calea București with traffic resistance at the intersection at ground level, with aboveground turn at the intersection of Calea București and Bvd. Carol I
- 2 underpass tunnels (one on each direction, one lane on each direction) on the Calea București relationship with Carol I underpass
- 2 underground pedestrian passages with Carol I underpass, on either side of Str. Calea București
- Mixed traffic section (pedestrian + bicycles + public transport) between Calea Unirii and Str. ARIEȘ
- Acquisition of land at the intersection of Arieș with Emperor Trajan for car access above-ground parking + reconfiguration of the intersection
- Above ground parking behind the Court with decommissioned CAO basin
- Redevelopment Str. Working Romania, public lighting + rehabilitation of historic house facades
- Rehabilitation Str. Giuseppe Peressutti
- Calea București widening by abolishing the parking lots adjacent to the road + other above-ground parking lots - to identify lands behind the first block front on Calea București for arranging residential multi-storey car parks
- Green area, street furniture, Wi-Fi near the Patria cinema

CARTIERUL VALEA ROȘIE

Delimitation: Str. Caracal, Str. Year 1848, Str. General Magheru, Str. Emperor Trajan, Str. Henri Coandă

Challenges, opportunities and proposals for regeneration in the neighborhood:

- The dormitories / blocks opposite the Stadium - to identify the legal regime, rehabilitation proposal
 - The land in front of Bl. 12 Vechi, Str. December 22 - unsanitary land, legal regime to be verified, redevelopment proposal
 - Elena Farago Kindergarten Yard - redevelopment + transformation into a semi-open sports base for the neighborhood
 - CAO basin opposite Bl. 25, Str. Revolution - demolition / rehabilitation proposal
 - Rehabilitation of Valea Roșie market
 - Area corresponding to the block of flats P11, P12, P15, Str. Pandurilor - generous land - multi-storey parking proposal
 - Proposal for multi-storey parking on the land in front of Block 14 - Priority Medical clinic
 - In front of the Nicolae Romanescu School - Str. Wind - land sports base proposal for the neighborhood
 - Land in front of the Profi store undeveloped - landscaping proposal
 - CAO basin behind Profi, adjacent to Str. Wind, demolition / rehabilitation proposal
 - Green area arrangement opposite the CAD pool next to block H6
 - Proposal for demolition of metal construction near the thermal point, opposite block e, sc. 4 (Heroes Owners Association)
 - Reconfiguration of the intersection Str. Emperor Trajan with Str. Henri Coandă, Str. Emperor Trajan with Str. Spaniei and Str. General Magheru with Str. Rovinari
 - Reconfiguration of the intersection Str. Caracal with Str. Henri Coandă
 - Reconfiguration of the intersection Str. Year 1848 with Str. General Magheru
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DIAGNOSTIC ANALYSIS: CONCLUSIONS, CHALLENGES, TRENDS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

Challenges, trends and needs identified	Recommendations
Regeneration of public space and anthropic and natural heritage resources	
Green space: - The location of the main municipal parks in the extremities of the city and the lack of non-motorized connections with the central area and the residential neighborhoods. - Poor access to green spaces in the collective housing neighborhoods in the east of the city (e.g. Rovine, Siloz, Lăpuș Argeș), in the peri-urban neighborhoods (e.g. Bariera Vâlcii, Bordei, Preajba Nouă, Banu Măracine). - The existence of inaccessible / undervalued areas covered with vegetation, around the blocks of flats in large collective housing neighborhoods. - Untapped green-blue resources in the peri-urban ring.	Expanding and capitalizing on green-blue resources to ensure equitable access to green space. - Pursuing the objective of equitable access to green space by ensuring 15 m² / capita within a 10-minute walking radius (800 m) - Utilization of the main mobility corridors as ecological corridors (bicycle lanes, safe sidewalks, separation of pedestrian space / bicycle traffic, etc.) - Capitalizing on green / open spaces in residential neighborhoods. - Identification of land resources within the peri-urban area, on which to build green spaces and neighborhood facilities. - Regeneration of green-blue resources inside the city and in the peri-urban area (Jiu meadow, ponds, Bucovăț forest) by building leisure spaces, bicycle tracks, etc. - Realization, publication and frequent updating of the green space registry, in order to build the legal framework to stop the restitution of green spaces / public domain, which are subsequently capitalized for real estate purposes. - In planning large residential projects, it is necessary for the developer, to ensure the necessary green space.
Mobility corridors with a high degree of accessibility: - Dominance of the car in prioritizing interventions and public transport. - The lack of dedicated parking spaces (at the level of neighborhoods) leads to overcrowding of streets and sidewalks with parked cars. - The quality of the pedestrian space is poor in many areas of the city, especially on the secondary streets and those of local importance. - The economic and social potential of the corridors with a high degree of accessibility is not sufficiently exploited, due to the poor quality of the urban space.	Increasing the quality of pedestrian space and facilitating a safe and comfortable environment, which involves: - Investments in pedestrian infrastructure to ensure sufficiently wide, unobstructed sidewalks, adequate public lighting, sufficiently frequent pedestrian crossings and even a level of shading to increase pedestrian comfort during the summer; - Enforcement of legislation on illegally parked cars on sidewalks and the installation of physical barriers to stop this practice, such as planters, parking limiters / bollards, or other elements of vegetation or street furniture. - Arranging spaces for rest and recreation, by introducing elements of street furniture in the squares and green areas in front of the blocks and in areas where the width of the sidewalks allows it. - Reconfigure the street profile to expand public space, calm traffic and where possible, to delimit a line dedicated to public transport.

Challenges, trends and needs identified	Recommendations
Regeneration of public space and anthropic and natural heritage resources	
Public space: • The continuous need to expand and improve the quality of public space, both in the central area and in residential areas. • Strengthening the local identity, by capitalizing on the architectural richness and activating the spaces in the central area. • Quality and equitable access to public spaces in the vicinity of the house, within 5-10 minutes walk. • Public spaces must be thought with special attention to architectural and urban details, human scale, safety and comfort, but also to concentrate as many functions as possible.	Integrated approach to public space regeneration projects: • Inventory and mapping of public assets and natural and heritage resources, including location, condition and information on the legal status of the property. ○ Collaboration with other state institutions for capitalizing on the objectives in their ownership / administration (e.g. Pelendava Roman ruins inside the Cosuna Monastery - owned by the Archdiocese of Craiova). ○ Applying fiscal policies to stimulate the restoration of privately owned architectural heritage. • Stimulating creativity in urban planning and architectural solutions by organizing design competitions. • Regeneration of public space and accessibility of the vicinity of a rehabilitation project and connection to pedestrian routes and public transport network. • Compliance with legislation and standards of good practice in ensuring the accessibility of people with motor disabilities and the blind in regeneration projects. • Activating / increasing the cultural offer and the use of rehabilitated spaces through partnerships with NGOs, private theaters, etc.
Built heritage: • Rapid degradation of heritage buildings and limitation of the capacity of public administration to carry out rehabilitation operations due to ambiguities on the legal status of property or due to poor dialogue between institutions holding public assets. • The rapid degradation of some privately owned heritage monuments, due to the lack of investments from the owners. • The lack of well-defined routes and signage elements (physical and digital) that unite and capitalize on the built heritage of the city, strengthening the image of the city.	Regeneration of heritage: • Rehabilitation of heritage buildings owned by the public administration and their functional reconversion for community purposes (e.g. community center). • Drawing up a vast tourist circuit, including historical monuments / memorial houses in the city, beyond those in the central area • Spatialization / mapping of historical monuments, elaboration of a strategy for connecting and capitalizing on them in a cultural and tourist circuit and then application of public policies to stimulate private investments, in parallel with interventions of the administration of regeneration of public space around them, for to increase the attractiveness and economic potential of these areas.

Challenges, trends and needs identified	Recommendations
Regeneration of public space and anthropic and natural heritage resources	
Aging building stock (apartment buildings, public institutions) that require architectural, structural and energy efficiency interventions, but also adaptation to new housing standards or the principles of universal accessibility.	• Renovation and energy rehabilitation of the old building stock, including the accessibility of buildings and ensuring high energy efficiency, aiming at net zero energy consumption. • Rehabilitation of the old buildings, through a comprehensive approach, which should include: ○ architectural interventions at the level of facades, to build a coherent and aesthetically pleasing image. ○ thermal rehabilitation and energy efficiency. ○ adapting buildings to the needs of an aging population by facilitating the accessibility of people with disabilities and the elderly, so that they are encouraged to have as active a life as possible. ○ arranging the terraces of the blocks for use in recreational activities. • Adopt a standard and a minimum set of technical indicators to be observed in carrying out capital repairs / thermal rehabilitation.
Integrated neighborhood regeneration	
Collective housing neighborhoods: • Old building stock, which needs energy, architectural and sometimes even structural rehabilitation. • Low quality of public space and insufficient green spaces for sports and recreation in the vicinity of the house. • Suffocation of public space, sidewalks and open spaces with cars and lack of prioritization of pedestrians and other non-motorized means of transport. • Overcrowding of social infrastructure (schools, kindergartens, etc.) as a result of families bringing their children from peri-urban and beyond.	Increasing the attractiveness of existing residential neighborhoods through their integrated urban regeneration: • Reconfiguration of public space and facilities for the community around "complete neighborhoods of 15 minutes" - within which residents have pedestrian access to public spaces and the main functions necessary for daily life. • Building new community spaces and facilities inside neighborhood units / urban islands - a service radius of 5 minutes (400 m), responding directly to the needs of local communities. • Capitalization and regeneration of schoolyards as spaces for the community (outside school hours). • Elaboration of a parking management strategy at the neighborhood level, by building underground or above-ground parking lots, including facilities for the neighborhood and by reorganizing the parking lots around urban islands, so as to facilitate pedestrian accessibility inside them. • Prioritize pedestrians in public space and improve poor pedestrian infrastructure.

Challenges, trends and needs identified	Recommendations
Integrated neighborhood regeneration	
Low-rise urban neighborhoods: • Low quality of pedestrian infrastructure and overcrowding of public space with parked cars. • Lack of social spaces, green spaces and neighborhood facilities. • Poor or overcrowded social infrastructure. • High density and lack of land resources to be used for community purposes.	• Ensuring equitable access to quality public infrastructure and services (sidewalks, lighting, schools, public spaces, etc.) • Efficient connection to the public transport network. • Reconfiguration of public space and facilities for the community around "15-minute neighborhoods" - within which residents have pedestrian access to public spaces and local services. • Prioritize pedestrians in public space and improve poor pedestrian infrastructure.
Peri-urban neighborhoods: • Deficiencies in the technical-urban infrastructure and the incremental development of the street plot, resulting in undersizing, unpaved streets and sidewalks missing long after the constructions appeared. • Lack of social infrastructure (e.g. schools, kindergartens), pedestrian infrastructure and neighborhood facilities. • High degree of fragmentation in plot development and low density - inefficient use of infrastructure.	• Covering the gaps in the technical-urban and transport infrastructure. • Equitable access to quality infrastructure and public services (sidewalks, lighting, schools, public spaces), etc. • Densification and functional diversification, according to the principles of sustainability and compact settlements. • Development of metropolitan transport and connection to the urban core and other main attractions. • Facilitating pedestrian / bicycle mobility and building neighborhood facilities - service radius 15 min.
Belonging villages: • Deficiencies in the technical-municipal and social infrastructure (e.g. schools, kindergartens), the pedestrian one and the local facilities. • Lack of effective connections with the urban core and the main attractions - dependence on the car or islands of social exclusion.	• Equitable access to quality infrastructure and public services (sidewalks, lighting, schools, public spaces), etc. • Efficient connection to the urban core by alternative means to the car. • Improving the pedestrian infrastructure and building local facilities, such as spaces for sports, leisure, playgrounds, etc.
Marginalized communities / informal settlements: • Areas with informal settlements or poor housing quality and very low comfort • Poor pedestrian, technical-municipal and social infrastructure. • Areas of social exclusion and lack of effective connections to the urban core and other major attractors.	• Equitable access to quality infrastructure and public services at affordable prices. • Construction of new social housing or regeneration of the built fund, where possible. • Community development, social integration and (re) qualification programs. • Connecting by public transport with employment opportunities.

